

# Appendix: How Bureaucracies Acquire Information from a Partisan Media Supply

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## A.1. Data

### A.1.1. Gemini Code

To extract named entities corresponding to media sources, I used the Gemini 2.0 Flash large language model (LLM) to perform entity recognition and classification. After splitting the DOI news briefings by page, I used the following prompt to extract the sources from each page using the Gemini LLM:

```
# Define the model
model_id = "gemini-2.0-flash"

# Define response schema
class Citation(BaseModel):
    source: str = Field(description="Name of news source cited in text. Reproduce the exact text. Write 'unable to determine' if not certain or no news source is detected.")
    sourceinfo: str = Field(description="All text related to the the news source and any associated text in () or []. Write 'unable to determine' if not certain or no news source is detected.")
    page: str = Field(description="Page number of pdf")
class Sources(BaseModel):
    """For each page of the pdf, extract the news sources cited in the document."""
    citations: list[Citation] = Field(description="The list of news sources")

# API Call
def extract_source_gemini(file_path: str, model: BaseModel):
    # Upload the file to the File API
    file = client.files.upload(file=file_path, onfig={'display_name': file_path.split('/')[-1].split('.')[0]})
    # Generate a structured response using the Gemini API
    prompt = f"Extract the structured data from the following PDF file"
    response = client.models.generate_content(model=model_id, contents=[prompt, file],
                                              config={'response_mime_type': 'application/json',
                                                    'response_schema': model})

    # Convert the response to the pydantic model and return it
    return response.parsed
```

### A.1.2. Media Bias/Fact Check (MBFC)

On June 2, 2025, I downloaded MBFC scores using the MBFC API (<https://rapidapi.com/mbfcnews/api/media-bias-fact-check-ratings-api2>). However, I merged the API data with additional information because MBFC combines its scores for partisan slant and factual accuracy. For sources that have been deemed factually questionable, the partisan slant score is replaced by ‘Questionable’ in the API database. Thus, to obtain partisan slant scores for all sources, I also scraped the MBFC website using the MBFC page URLs provided by the API. I identified several places where partisan slant data could be found on the website (a table in the text and the filename of an image).

To construct a bias variable from these three sources of information (the API, website text, and website image filename), I first created flag variables for each category. I created a variable called `right`, which was 1 if the source was categorized as ‘right’ by the API, webpage text, or webpage image filename. I also created a variable called `left`, which would be 1 if the source was categorized as ‘left’ by the API, webpage text, or webpage image filename. Lastly, I created a variable called `center`, which would be 1 if the source was categorized as ‘least biased’ by the API, webpage text, or webpage image filename. I created a variable called `other`, which was equal to 1 if the source was categorized as a ‘satire’ by by the API, webpage text, or webpage image filename. Lastly, I created a variable called `notrated`, which was 1 if the source was not categorized as right, left, center, or other (e.g. it was listed as “not rated”, “na”, “unrated”, “pro-science”, “pseudoscience”, or “junk news”). `notrated` was also 1 if the source was listed as both right and left.

To construct a final partisan bias variable, I used the following rules to determine whether a source was categorized as left, right, center, other, or not categorized:

- Right-leaning: (`right=1`) and (`left=0`)
- Left-leaning: (`left=1`) and (`right=0`)
- Center: (`center=1`) and (`right=left=0`)
- Other: (`other=1`) and (`center=right=left=0`)
- Not Categorized: ((`notrated=1`) and (`other=center=right=left=0`)) OR (`right=left=1`)

Some webpages also provided the numeric score for partisan bias as well. However, most of them were missing the negative sign (-) if they were liberal. Thus, I recalculated the numeric scores by multiplying the number by -1 if the score was from a liberal-leaning website. These continuous scores are available for only part of the sample. They are only used in the Appendix as a robustness check and to determine source extremity.

Table A1: Agreement between MBFC and Allsides Scores

| Source Type      | Total Sources | Total Agree | Percent Agreement |
|------------------|---------------|-------------|-------------------|
| Excluded (local) | 577           | 335         | 58.1              |
| Included         | 250           | 190         | 76.0              |

## Comparison of partisan slant scores

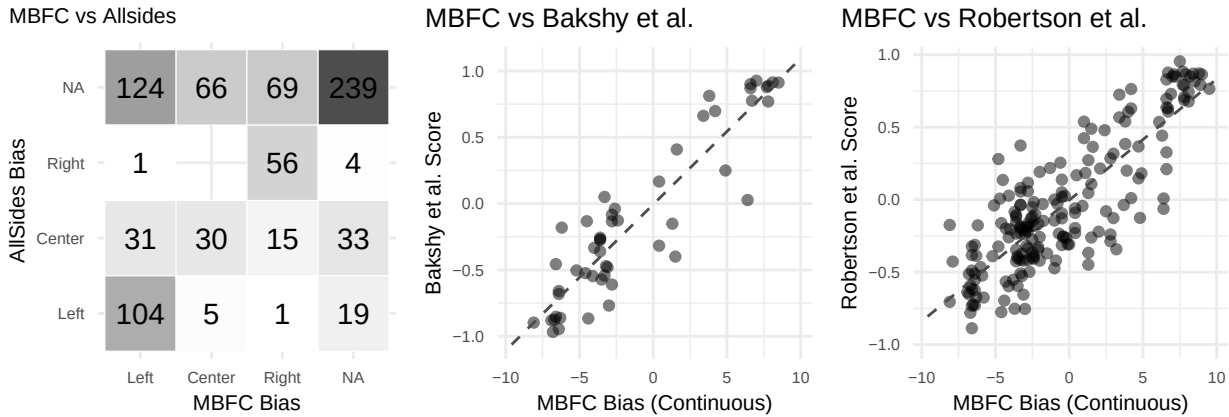


Figure A1: Comparison of media bias scores. Limited to sources cited in briefings. Excludes local general interest sources and government websites.

### A.1.3. Summary Statistics

Table A2: Summary Stats for Briefings and Agencies

| Briefing | Agency | Part of Briefing | Years     | Total Articles | Total Dates | Avg Articles per Day | Unique Source Domains | Unique Source Names | Local General Interest | Gov Websites | Unidentified | International |
|----------|--------|------------------|-----------|----------------|-------------|----------------------|-----------------------|---------------------|------------------------|--------------|--------------|---------------|
| DOI      | DOI    | Whole Briefing   | 2015-2018 | 37,848         | 213         | 177.7                | 2,110                 | 2,287               | 10,761                 | 4            | 0            | 11,071        |
| DOI      | BLM    | Section          | 2015-2018 | 1,342          | 210         | 6.4                  | 313                   | 321                 | 817                    | 0            | 0            | 825           |
| DOI      | FWS    | Section          | 2015-2018 | 2,154          | 210         | 10.3                 | 586                   | 604                 | 1,060                  | 1            | 0            | 1,138         |
| DOI      | GS     | Section          | 2015-2018 | 562            | 160         | 3.5                  | 240                   | 245                 | 239                    | 0            | 0            | 268           |
| DOI      | NPS    | Section          | 2015-2018 | 3,256          | 212         | 15.4                 | 728                   | 767                 | 1,751                  | 0            | 0            | 1,810         |
| DOI      | BOR    | Section          | 2016-2018 | 266            | 104         | 2.6                  | 128                   | 130                 | 172                    | 0            | 0            | 175           |
| DOI      | BIA    | Section          | 2017-2018 | 454            | 128         | 3.5                  | 161                   | 162                 | 222                    | 0            | 0            | 222           |
| VA       | VA     | Whole Briefing   | 2020-2021 | 6,099          | 233         | 26.2                 | 1,671                 | 1,261               | 3,588                  | 87           | 38           | 3,664         |
| USCIS    | USCIS  | Whole Briefing   | 2022-2025 | 44,420         | 922         | 48.2                 | 1,845                 | 2,159               | 17,596                 | 47           | 4            | 17,219        |
| DHS      | DHS    | Whole Briefing   | 2024-2025 | 70,346         | 655         | 107.4                | 1,295                 | 1,394               | 8,566                  | 200          | 134          | 8,541         |
| DHS      | CG     | Section          | 2024-2025 | 2,648          | 583         | 4.5                  | 284                   | 341                 | 725                    | 38           | 10           | 681           |
| DHS      | FEMA   | Section          | 2024-2025 | 6,394          | 643         | 9.9                  | 287                   | 284                 | 1,132                  | 2            | 17           | 1,026         |
| DHS      | SS     | Section          | 2024-2025 | 3,622          | 567         | 6.4                  | 844                   | 830                 | 1,493                  | 148          | 1            | 1,658         |
| DHS      | TSA    | Section          | 2024-2025 | 1,379          | 454         | 3.0                  | 126                   | 142                 | 239                    | 3            | 9            | 188           |
| DHS      | USCBP  | Section          | 2024-2025 | 4,504          | 648         | 7.0                  | 161                   | 168                 | 827                    | 2            | 11           | 797           |
| DHS      | USCIS  | Section          | 2024-2025 | 2,755          | 591         | 4.7                  | 145                   | 133                 | 288                    | 1            | 7            | 280           |
| DHS      | USICE  | Section          | 2024-2025 | 7,576          | 618         | 12.3                 | 285                   | 281                 | 1,140                  | 2            | 20           | 1,047         |
| Total    |        |                  | 2015-2025 | 158,713        | 1,563       | 101.5                | 4,081                 | 4,393               | 40,511                 | 338          | 176          | 40,495        |

## A.2. Figure 1 - Association between sources in briefings and partisan slant

Table A3 contains the regression coefficients for the best fit line in the right-leaning subplot of Figure 1. The table also shows that these results are consistent across different specifications. Figure A2 replicates Figure 1 using different media slant measures and shows the relationship between missing slant and agency ideology. Figure A3 replicates Figure 1 using an alternate agency ideology measure from Napolio (2025).

Table A3: Best fit line in Right-leaning subplot of Figure 2 (aggregated data)

|                           | MBFC                      | MBFC, keep NA             | MBFC, disaggregated      | MBFC, continuous          | MBFC, keep local+gov      | Alt ideo measure          |
|---------------------------|---------------------------|---------------------------|--------------------------|---------------------------|---------------------------|---------------------------|
| (Intercept)               | 0.200 (0.024)***          | 0.184 (0.023)***          | 0.268 (0.076)**          | 0.461 (0.010)***          | 0.201 (0.018)***          | 0.166 (0.017)***          |
| Agency Ideology           | 0.062 (0.018)**           | 0.059 (0.017)**           | 0.052 (0.012)***         | 0.025 (0.008)**           | 0.048 (0.016)**           |                           |
| Agency Ideology (Napolio) |                           |                           |                          |                           |                           | 0.019 (0.002)***          |
| Num.Obs.                  | 17                        | 17                        | 136382                   | 17                        | 17                        | 17                        |
| R2                        | 0.302                     | 0.293                     | 0.009                    | 0.290                     | 0.282                     | 0.703                     |
| R2 Adj.                   | 0.256                     | 0.246                     | 0.009                    | 0.242                     | 0.234                     | 0.683                     |
| Std.Errors                | Heteroskedasticity-robust | Heteroskedasticity-robust | by: Source & Agency & ID | Heteroskedasticity-robust | Heteroskedasticity-robust | Heteroskedasticity-robust |

Notes: Cols 1-2: Dependent variable (DV) is porportion of articles in an agency's briefing from right-leaning sources, ranges from 0 to 1.

Col 3: DV is 1 if an article is from a right-leaning sources and 0 otherwise. Errors clustered by the agency, news sources, and article.

Col 4: DV is the average value of the MBFC continuous variable, rescaled from 0-1.

Col 4: DV is same as col 1, Ricardson et al agency ideology scores replaced with scores from Napolio (2025), ranges from -10 to 10.

Figure 1 replicates with other partisan slant measures

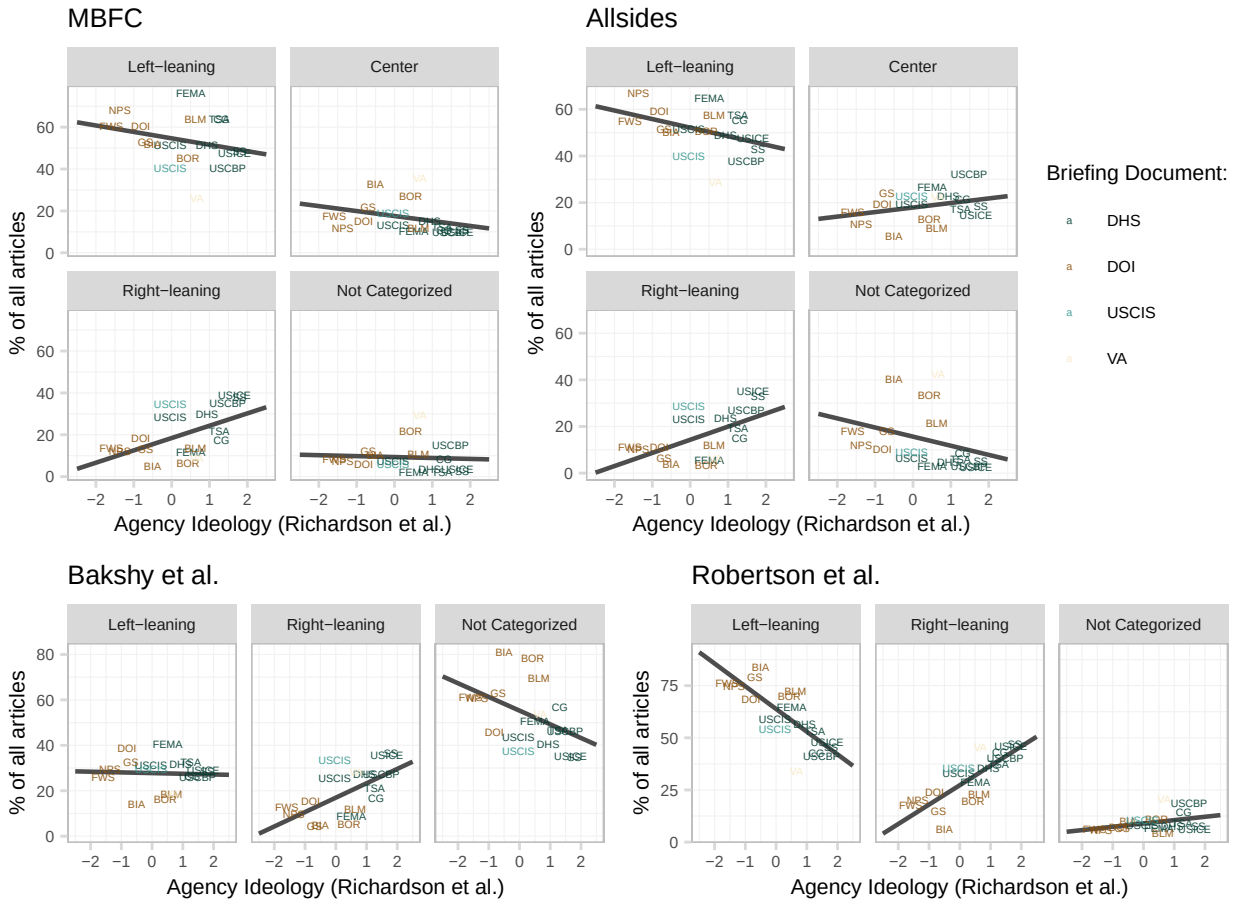


Figure A2: Replication of Figure 1 with alternate partisan slant scores.

Figure 1 replicates with other agency ideology measure

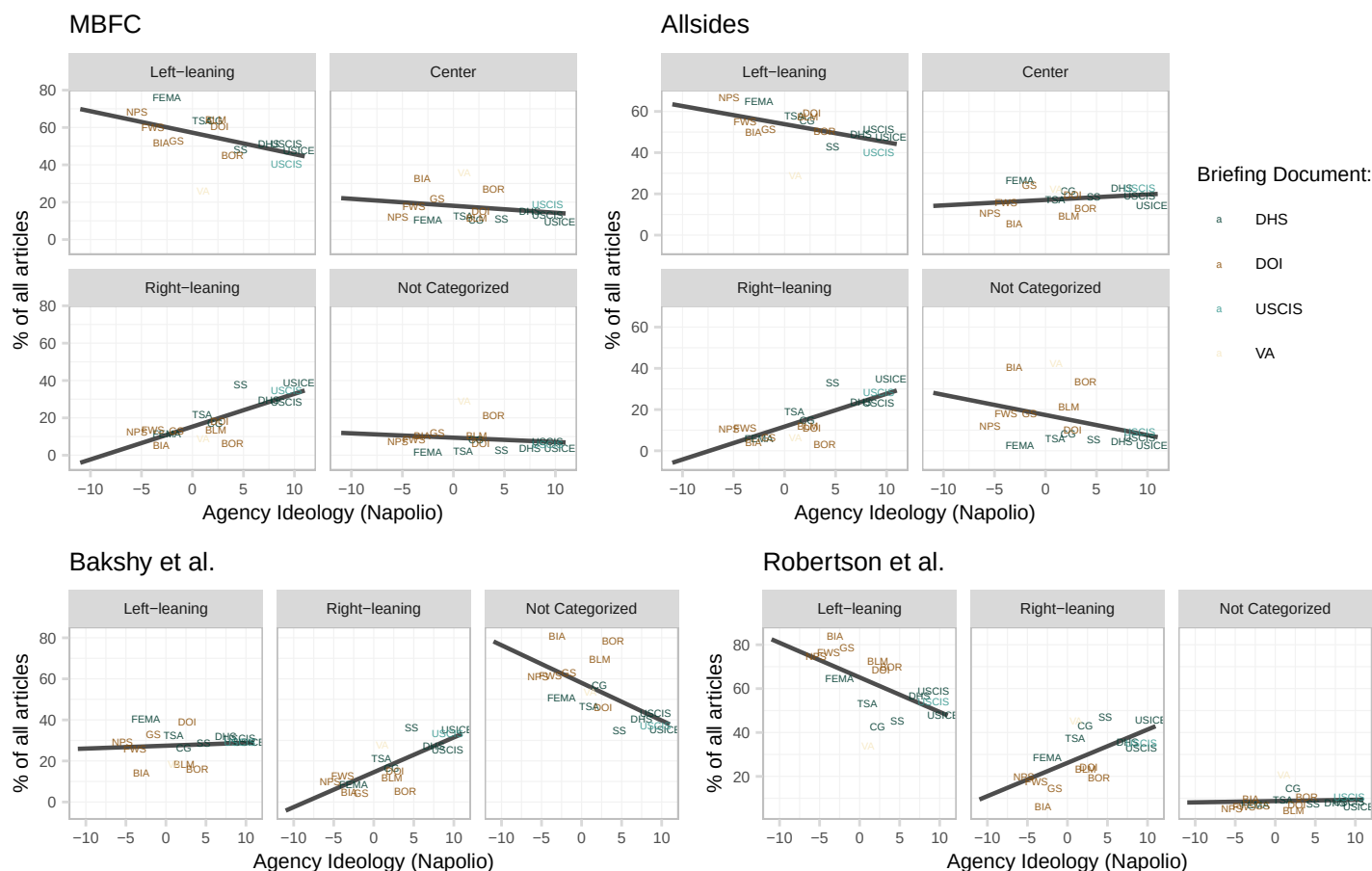


Figure A3: Replication of Figure 1 with Napolio (2025) agency ideology measures.

### A.3. Figure 3 - Association between news supply and partisan slant

Because I do not have the complete set of daily news briefings for the Department of Interior, I had to make an assumption about which articles from Media Cloud should be considered part of the supply for Figure 3(i).<sup>1</sup> In Figure A4, I show that most articles were included in the briefing 1 day after being published. However, there is some variation. Breaking down the distribution by the day of the week that the briefing was published (Monday, Tuesday, etc), we see that Monday briefings include slightly older articles. I did not find any Sunday DOI briefings, suggesting that DOI briefings are not produced on Sundays. Likely, Monday briefings contain coverage from Saturday and Sunday. Thus, when I determined the relevant supply of news for the DOI briefings in my sample, I included an extra day for briefings published on Mondays. The results reported in Figures 3(i) and 4 assume that an article is part of the DOI's relevant supply of news if it is published on the same day as a briefing in my sample or 1 day prior to a briefing in my sample. For briefings published on Mondays, I include articles published up to 2 days before a briefing in my sample briefing.

The other figures below test the robustness of the findings in Figure 3. Figure A5 compares the slope of the best fit line in Figure 3(i) to the comparable best fit line of Figure 1 (after removing sources not found in Media Cloud). Across different specifications, the supply-side disparity is similar sized or larger than the disparity in the briefings. Figure A6 reproduces Figure 3(ii) for each facet in Figure (i) and treats missing slant as a fourth slant category. Figures A7 and A8 replicate Figure 3(ii) using other slant measures. Figure A9 replicates Figure 3(ii) with different samples (e.g. results when local news is included).

<sup>1</sup>Note that I have not replicated Figure 3(i) using the GDELT data. This is because the GDELT API does not report article publication date.

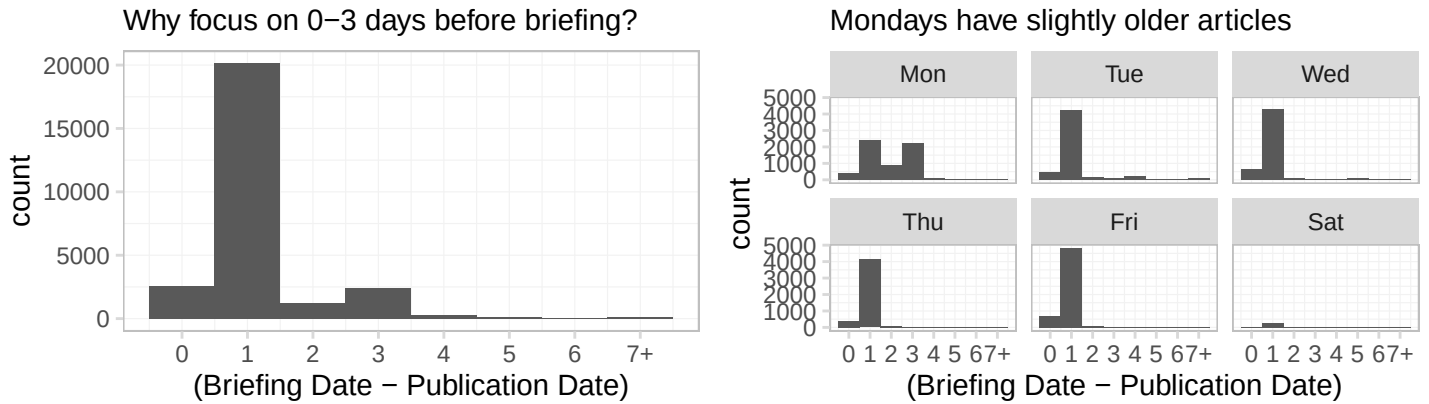


Figure A4: Days between DOI briefing and article publication. Based on article publication date metadata provided in DOI briefing. Excludes local general interest sources and government websites. Plot (ii) shows the distribution grouped by the day of the week of the briefing. No DOI briefings were found for Sundays, suggesting that they are only produced 6 days a week.

### Robustness checks for Figure 3(i)

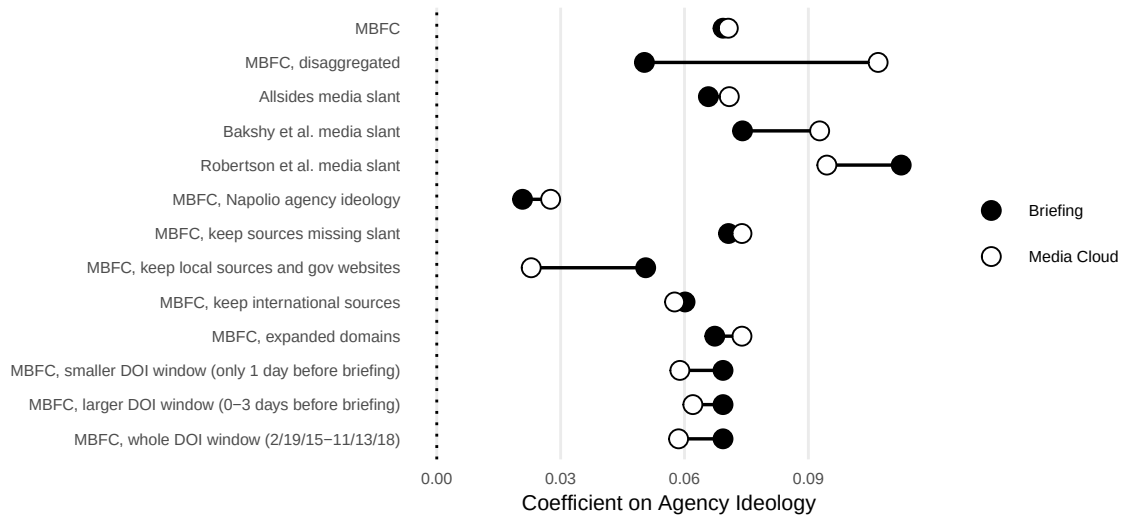


Figure A5: Robustness of finding in Figure 3(i). Open dots are estimates from regressions using Media cloud data. Closed dots are estimates from regressions using briefing data, after dropping articles from sources that do not appear in the Media Cloud sample.

### Distribution of Agency News Coverage (Media Cloud) by Agency Ideology (Richardson et al.)

Randomly sampled 4 weeks every 6 months from Jan 2015 to May 2025.

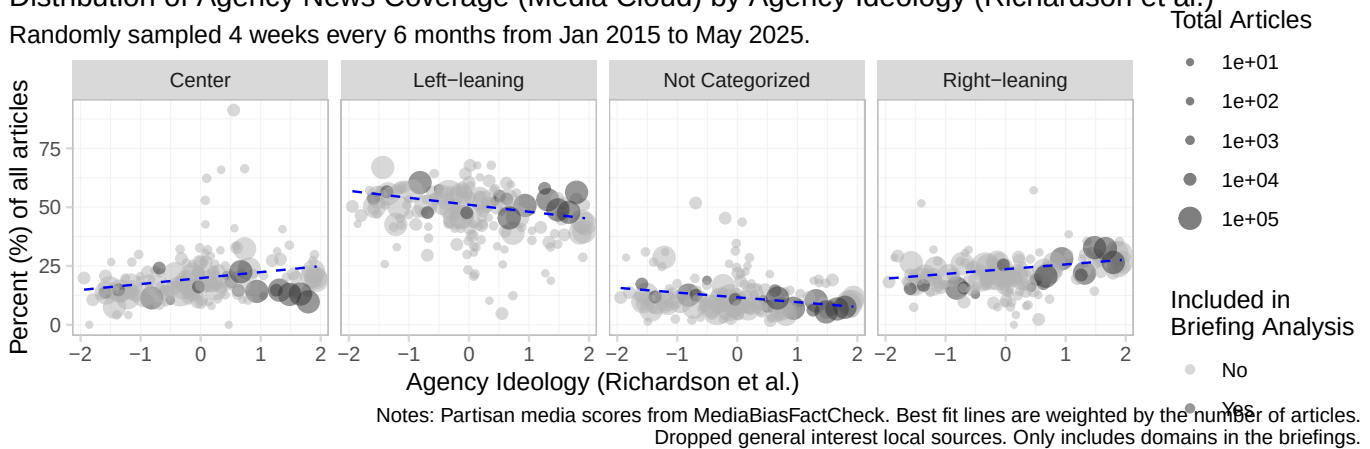


Figure A6: Version of Fig 3(ii) with all media slant categories.

Figure 3 using alternative bias and ideology measures, Media Cloud (2015–2025)

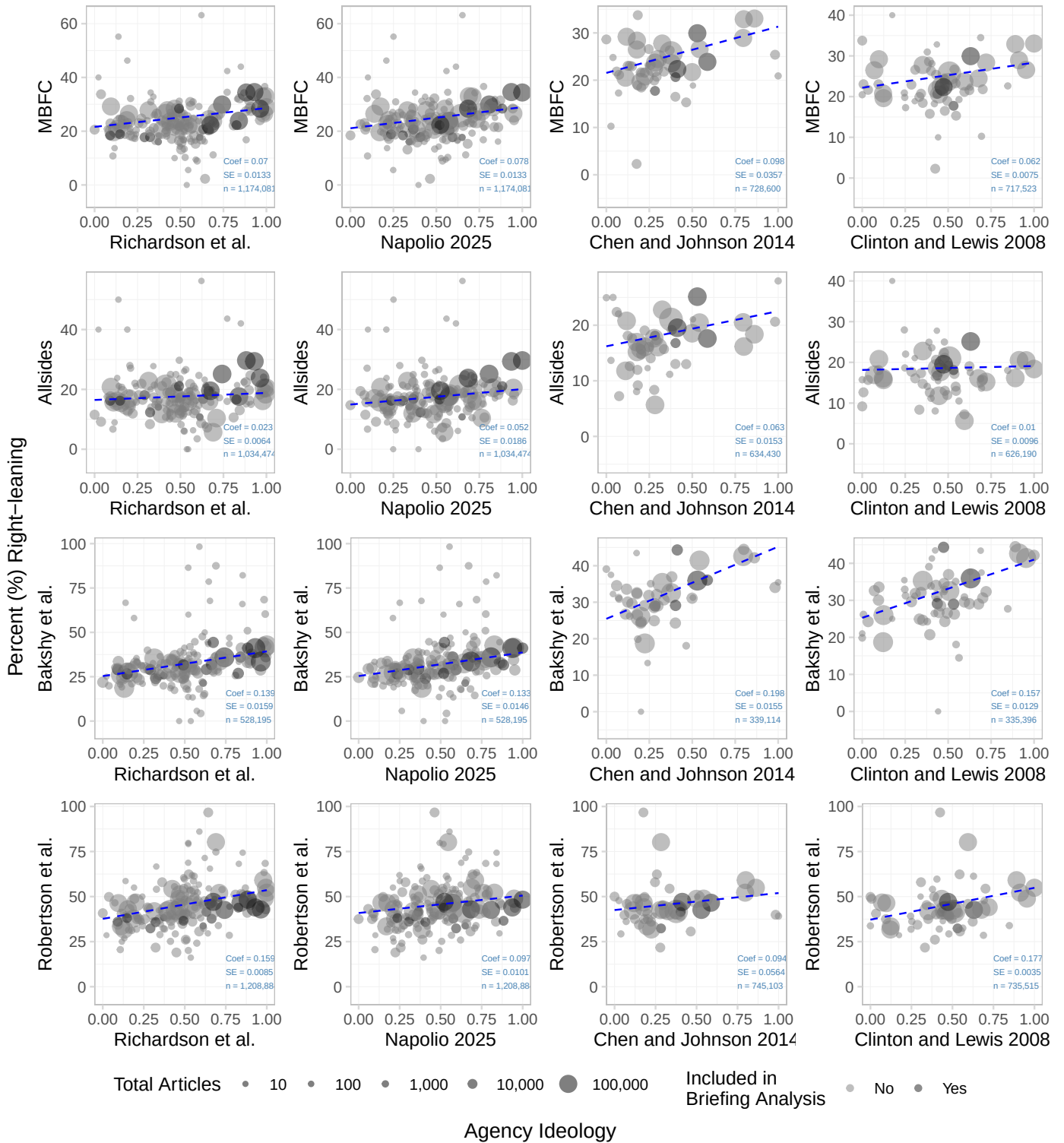


Figure A7: Replication of Fig 3(ii) using alternative measures of news slant and agency ideology.

### Robustness of Figure 3(ii) – Continuous bias measures, Media Cloud (2015–2025)

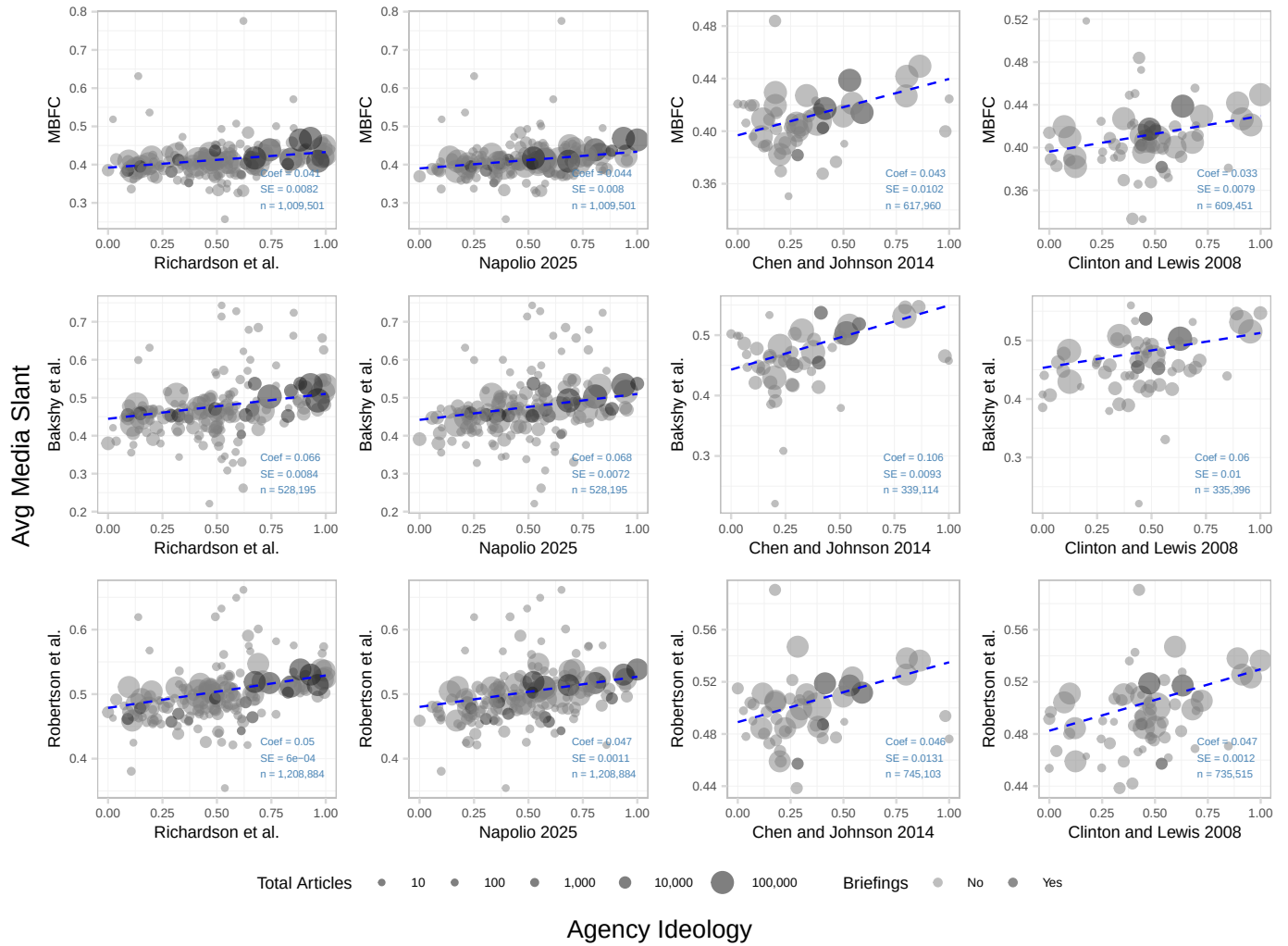


Figure A8: Replication of Fig 3(ii) using continuous measures of slant from MBFC and Bakshy et al. (2015). Slant rescaled to between 0 and 1.

### Robustness of Figure 3(ii) - Different samples

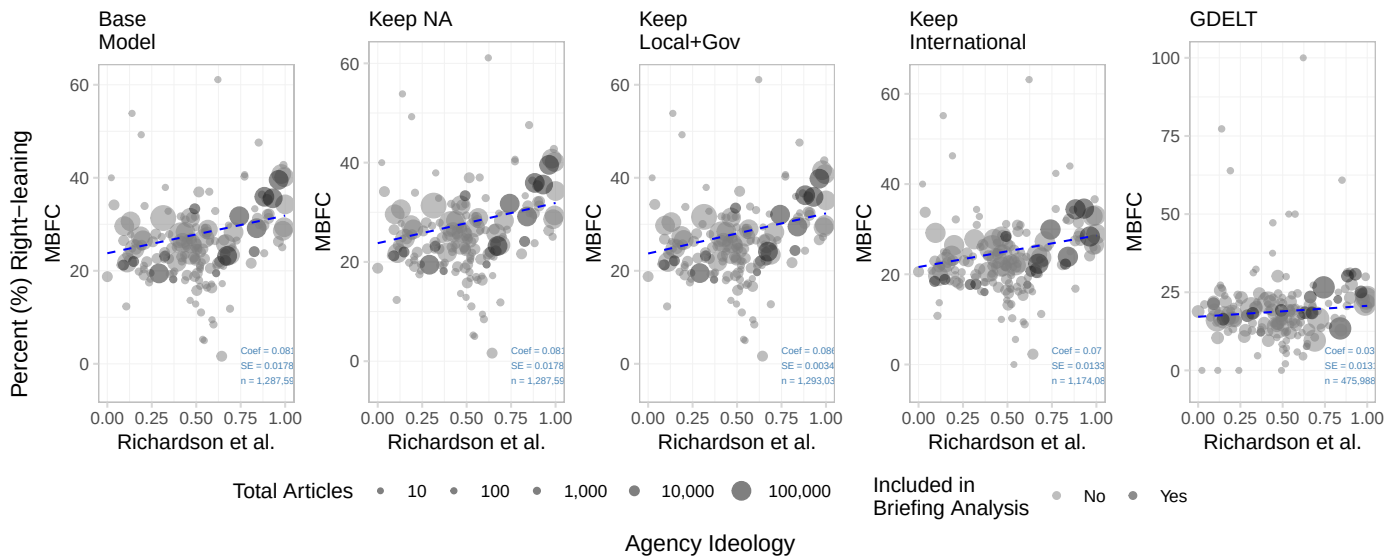


Figure A9: Replication of Fig 3(ii) with alternate data subsets and sources. Fig 3(ii) results after keeping articles with missing media slant, keeping local general interest news and government websites, keeping international sources, and substituting GDELT data.



Table A4: Random effects model

|                                        | DV: Percent         |                     |                      |                      |
|----------------------------------------|---------------------|---------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
|                                        | Right               | Center              | Left                 | Not Categorized      |
| (Intercept)                            | 3.088***<br>(0.704) | 3.762***<br>(0.808) | 2.500***<br>(0.212)  | 12.103***<br>(1.407) |
| Agency Ideology                        | 0.309***<br>(0.073) | -0.062<br>(0.201)   | -0.157***<br>(0.031) | -0.211**<br>(0.072)  |
| SD (Intercept Source)                  | 6.626               | 6.731               | 2.808                | 23.241               |
| SD (Agency Ideology Source)            | 0.609               | 1.595               | 0.253                | 0.803                |
| Cor (Intercept~Agency Ideology Source) | 0.986               | -0.426              | -0.693               | -0.105               |
| SD (Observations)                      | 2.811               | 2.970               | 2.701                | 4.060                |
| Num.Obs.                               | 6938                | 4472                | 12359                | 8819                 |
| R2 Marg.                               | 0.002               | 0.000               | 0.002                | 0.000                |
| R2 Cond.                               | 0.850               | 0.843               | 0.522                | 0.970                |
| RMSE                                   | 2.79                | 2.93                | 2.68                 | 3.97                 |

+ p < 0.1, \* p < 0.05, \*\* p < 0.01, \*\*\* p < 0.001

Notes: Data is aggregated to the source-agency level. DV is the proportion of a source's coverage that mentions an agency (out of 100).

Model is run separately for sources belonging to each Media Bias Fact Check (MBFC) category. The following articles were dropped from all models: articles without urls, local general interest sources, government websites, and international news sources.

Estimated random effects model using lmer() from lme4 package. Allows for random intercepts and random slopes for each source.

#### A.4. Extension of Figure 3(ii) Analysis - Outlet-level heterogeneous effects

While Figure 3 in the main paper suggests that publication decisions explain why conservative and liberal agencies receive different amount of coverage, the pattern could be the result of several large news outlets. Because Media Cloud does not contain all news outlets in the briefings, a supply-side explanation is more plausible if individual-level right- and left-leaning news outlets generally display asymmetric coverage of agencies.

The y-intercept and slope of the best fit line in Figure 3 depend on the ratio of conservative vs non-conservative news sources in the Media Cloud sample, the maximum output of each source, and how each source decides to allocate its resources to different stories. Because the ratio and output are fixed for each time period, any differences in the amount of coverage a news outlet gives to a particular agency will be the product of publication/editorial decisions.

To test for heterogeneous effects, I first run a mixed-effects model, allowing the slope and intercept of the regression to vary for each source (see Table A4). To run this model, I first aggregate the data to the source-agency level. For every source, I calculate the proportion of coverage that it dedicates to each agency ( $pct_{ij}$ ). This proportion, scaled from 0 to 100, is the outcome variable. To account for the possibility that different media outlets respond differently to agency ideology, I include random intercepts and random slopes for agency ideology by news outlet, allowing both the baseline level of coverage and the ideological effect to vary by outlet. This specification captures outlet-specific deviations from the average relationship and models heterogeneity in how agencies cite different sources. Formally, the model can be written as  $pct_{ij} = \beta_0 + \beta_1 I_{ij} + \mu_{0j} + \mu_{1j} I_{ij} + \epsilon_{ij}$  where  $I_{ij}$  is the ideology of agency,  $i$ , which varies within media outlet,  $j$ . Rather than include interactions between agency ideology and media slant, I split the sample and run separate models for each media slant category (see Table A4).

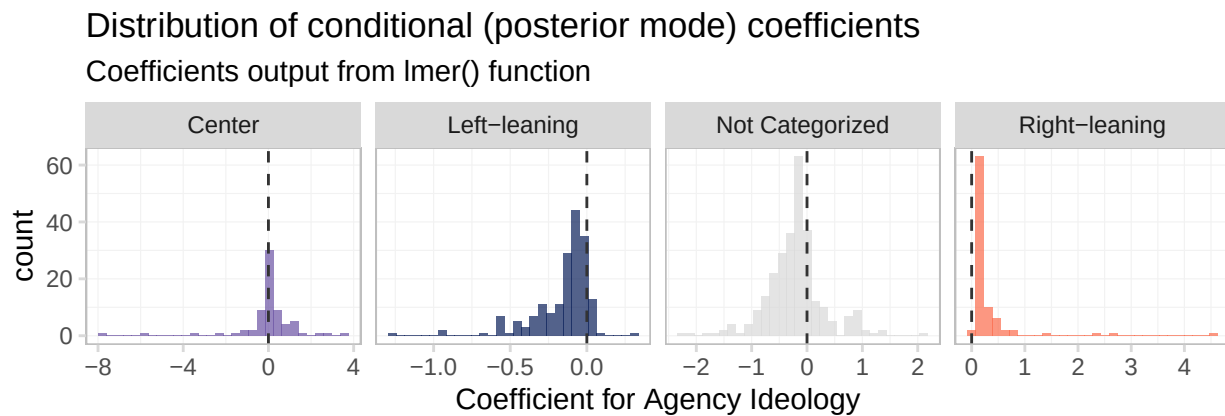


Figure A10: Effect of agency ideology on the proportion of news dedicated to liberal vs conservative agencies. Coefficients from calculated separately for each news source. Resulting coefficients grouped by the slant of the media outlet (MBFC). Outcome is the percent of news (0-100) that an agency receives from a news source. Uses same data as Figure 3, aggregated to the source-agency level.

## Distribution of agency ideology coefficients by media slant category

Independently estimated for each source

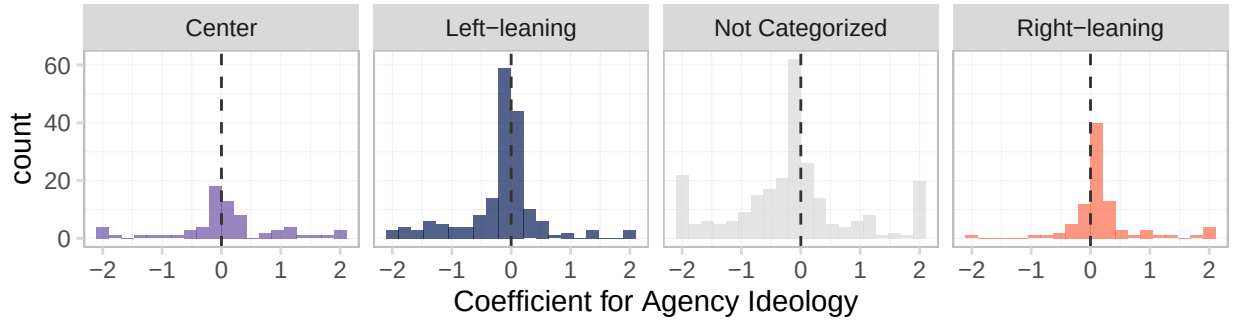


Figure A11: Effect of agency ideology on the proportion of news dedicated to liberal vs conservative agencies. To get coefficients, ran separate regression for each news source. Source dropped if regression could not be computed (e.g. 1 data point). Resulting coefficients grouped by the slant of the media outlet (MBFC). Outcome is the percent of news (0-100) that an agency receives from a news source. Uses same data as Figure 3, aggregated to the source-agency level. Truncated coefficient values above 2 or below -2.

To ensure that these results were not driven by a small number of high-frequency outlets, I also estimated separate linear regressions of the share of citations on agency ideology for each news source. For each news source,  $j$ , I run a separate OLS regression ( $pct_{ij} = \beta_{0j} + \beta_{1j}I_{ij} + \epsilon_{ij}$ ) for each news outlet,  $j$ , and plot the resulting coefficients ( $\beta_{1j}$ ). The resulting distribution of coefficients (see Figure A11) mirrors the general pattern in the conditional estimates from the mixed-effects model, suggesting that the findings are not the artifact of a single dominant outlet. In Figure A11, the coefficients are unweighted.

Like the initial OLS results, the results of the mixed-effects model also indicate a positive relationship between agency ideology and the share of coverage from right-leaning outlets. On average, more conservative agencies cited right-leaning sources more frequently. To verify that this relationship is not limited to a few news outlets, I plot the distribution of conditional (posterior mode) coefficients for agency ideology (see Figure A10). These coefficients are outlet-specific estimates of the effect of agency ideology, extracted from a mixed-effects model that allows both intercepts and slopes to vary by media outlet. They reflect how the ideology of an agency affects the amount of news a source publishes about that agency.

In Figure A10, nearly all of the right-leaning sources are positive, indicating that right-leaning sources publish more articles about conservative agencies, relative to liberal ones. Figure A10 also shows that left-leaning sources right-leaning publish more articles about liberal agencies, relative to conservative ones. The coefficients for center and not categorized sources are both centered close to zero. Together, these results suggest that the supply-side asymmetry is driven by both left- and right-leaning news sources.

### A.5. Matching Media Cloud to the Briefings

For the analysis in Figure 4, I match the articles in the Media Cloud dataset to the briefings. The resulting ‘matched sample’ contains all published articles that mention each agency name and an outcome variable that is 1 if the article is matched to the briefings and 0 otherwise. I used two different methods to match the Media Cloud results to the briefings:

1. **URL match:** If an article with the same URL (identified by EITHER option A or B below) could be found in the relevant briefing the article was counted as included. In practice, both URL matching options produce almost identical results. When matching by URL, I consider the whole briefing, not just the appropriate section. Thus, if an article mentioning US Immigration and Customs Enforcement (USICE) is placed in the “Top News” section, I count it as being included in the briefing. When determining which Media Cloud sources to include, I include any source used in the entire briefing, not just the section relevant to an agency. The DOI briefings do not contain article URLs, so this method was only possible for the VA, DHS, and USCIS briefings.
  - Option 1(A): Match by whole URL.
  - Option 1(B): Match by domain and ‘slug.’ The slug is defined as the longest text segment of the URL path. In practice, I first removed the query text and text following the query. I then split the text between the domain suffix and the end of the URL by forward slash. If there were multiple segments, I selected the longest one.
2. **Source+Date match:** If an article with the same news source and publication date could be found in the relevant briefing or section of briefing, all articles from that news source were counted as included. For the subagencies, I only searched for a match in their subsection of the briefing. Thus, if an article mentioning an agency name is included in another section (e.g. the ‘Top news’ section), it will not be counted. The VA briefings do not report publication date, so this method was only possible for the DOI, DHS, and USCIS briefings. To reduce false positives, I removed three national news sections from the DOI briefing before matching (“TOP NATIONAL NEWS”, “BIG PICTURE”, “EDITORIAL WRAP-UP”).

Table A5: Comparison of URL and Source+Date matching methods.

| 'Error' Type                                                      | Briefing | Total   | %    |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|---------|------|
| 'Correct' (URL match equals Source+Date match)                    | DHS      | 121,483 | 77.8 |
| 'Correct' (URL match equals Source+Date match)                    | USCIS    | 168     | 81.6 |
| 'False Negative' (URL match positive, Source+Date match negative) | DHS      | 4,885   | 3.1  |
| 'False Negative' (URL match positive, Source+Date match negative) | USCIS    | 1       | 0.5  |
| 'False Positive' (URL match negative, Source+Date match positive) | DHS      | 29,863  | 19.1 |
| 'False Positive' (URL match negative, Source+Date match positive) | USCIS    | 37      | 18.0 |

Table A6: Comparison of URL and Source+Date matching methods.

| 'Error' Type                                                      | DHS-CG | DHS-DHS | DHS-FEMA | DHS-SS | DHS-TSA | DHS-USCBP | DHS-USCIS | DHS-USICE | USCIS-USCIS |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|---------|----------|--------|---------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-------------|
| 'Correct' (URL match equals Source+Date match)                    | 86.6   | 70.0    | 75.7     | 85.5   | 88.6    | 83.0      | 83.2      | 79.2      | 81.6        |
| 'False Negative' (URL match positive, Source+Date match negative) | 4.1    | 0.1     | 4.7      | 3.2    | 5.1     | 8.1       | 8.7       | 5.9       | 0.5         |
| 'False Positive' (URL match negative, Source+Date match positive) | 9.3    | 30.0    | 19.5     | 11.3   | 6.3     | 8.9       | 8.1       | 14.8      | 18.0        |

In the paper, I use the first matching strategy (Source+Date) to generate Figure 4 because dropping the DOI briefings reduces the sample size. Additionally, matching by Source+Date produces reasonably similar results as the URL match. To test the accuracy of the Source+Date matching strategy, I compare the results of the matching strategies for USCIS and DHS briefings.

Table A5 shows how often the Source+Date matching strategy produced different results from the URL matching strategy. For about 20% of articles, the Source+Date strategy produces a possible 'false positive' (where the Source+Date strategy identifies a match and the URL strategy does not identify a match). Note that some of these are not true false positives because they include cases where the URL matching strategy produced a false negative. For example, if an article has multiple URLs, URL matching may undercount the number of included articles. In Figure A12 I plot the 'false positive' rate (percent of articles that are matched by the Source+Date method and not matched by the URL method) by the number of articles from each source.

Note that the 'False Negative' rate in Tables A5 and A6 is mostly an artifact of the matching process. This can occur when an article mentions a subagency's name but is included in a different section of the briefing (e.g. an article mentioning ICE is included in the 'top news' section). It can also occur when the publication date is wrong in one of the datasets. To reduce false positives for subagencies, I only considered articles from the subagency's section of the news briefing for the Source+Date matches. Table A5 shows that the 'false positive' rate is much higher for the whole briefings (DHS-DHS, USCIS-USCIS). This is because there is a higher chance that another article from the same source is included.

Figure A12 also raises another possible issue. For some audio and video media formats, the briefings provide a link to a server rather than the original source website. If the story was also posted on the source website and scraped by Media Cloud, the URL match would be incorrect. To verify that the results are not biased by the inclusion of audio and video formats, I replicate the results for Figure 4 after dropping TV and Radio media sources.

Figure A13 shows the proportion of articles missing partisan slant in the matched sample. Especially for the Source+Date match, partisan slant is missing for slightly more of the unmatched articles.

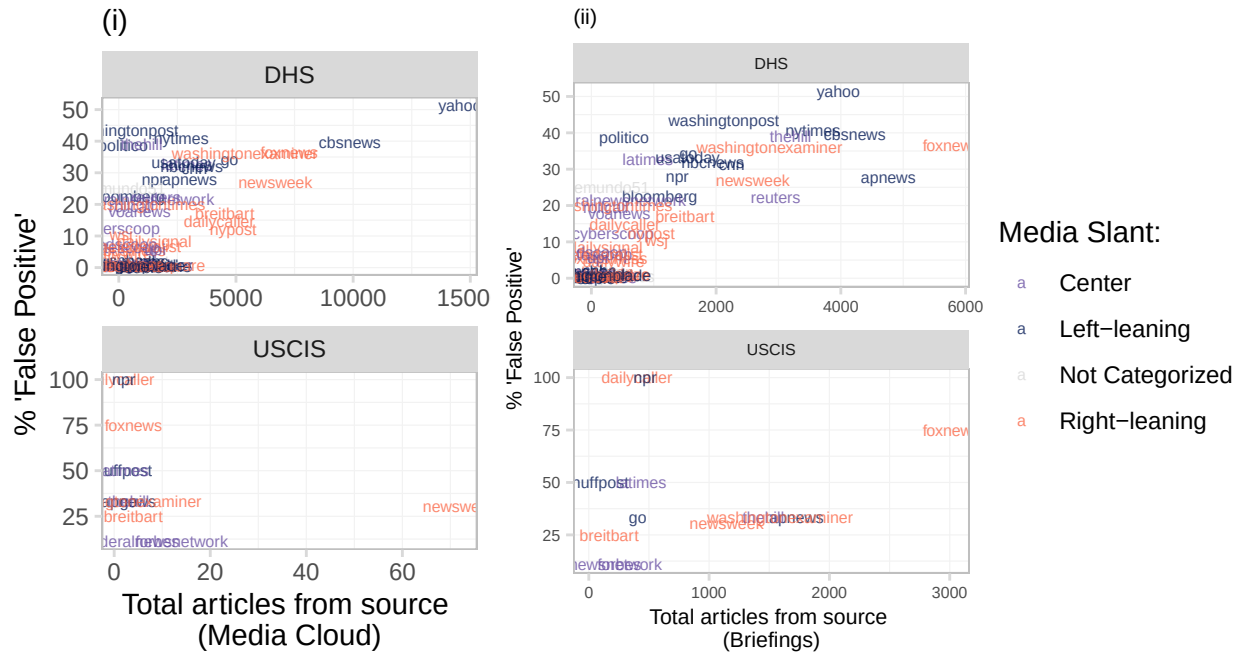


Figure A12: Association between 'false positives' (articles that are matched by the Source+Date method and not matched by the URL method) and the number of articles from each source. In subplot (i), the x-axis is the total number of articles in the Media Cloud sample from each sources. In subplot (ii), the x-axis is the total number of articles in the Briefing sample from each source.

#### Articles missing partisan slant in matched sample

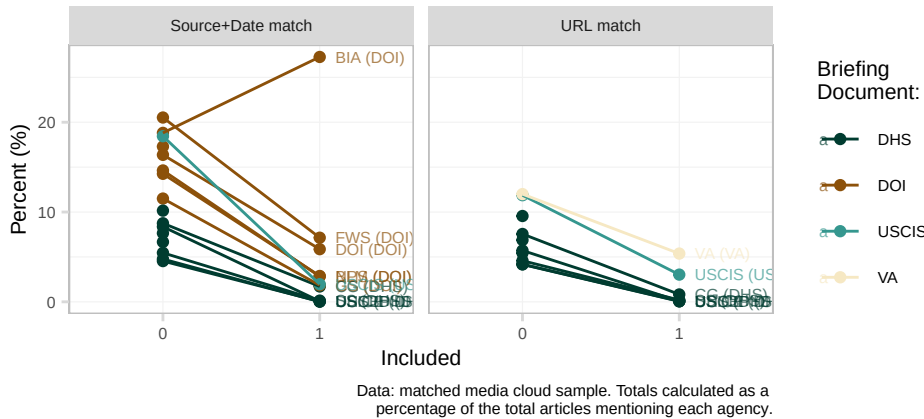


Figure A13: Percent of articles in matched sample that are missing partisan slant. In Source+Date match, dropped yahoo.com.

## A.6. Testing Whether Agency Names are a Good Method for Identifying Potentially Relevant News

**Should agency names be used as a proxy for the keywords used to define potentially relevant news?** - I also tested whether the articles that I identified as 'included' are representative of the larger briefing sample. If the matching strategy was perfect and the Media Cloud sample was complete, matching would identify all articles that mention an agency name. While the matching strategy is not perfect, it can help us understand how many articles mention each agency's name.

Using the URL match, I identify the proportion of briefing articles matched to the media cloud sample. In other words, I estimate the minimum number of articles in the briefings that mention an agency by name (see Table A7). To make the results as comparable as possible, I only include domains and dates that are included in the matched dataset.

For most sub-agencies, over a third of the articles could be matched to the briefings, suggesting that at least a third of the articles mention the agency by name. However, there are a few outliers. In the DHS briefing, only 18.0128588% of articles could be matched to an article with the agency's name. This is probably because many articles in the DHS refer to subagencies. Of the articles in the DHS briefing, 24.8902083% contain the agency name or the name of one of the 7 subagencies. FEMA is another outlier, probably because it contains articles about developing natural disasters, even when the articles do not mention the agency by name. USCIS is a major outlier. Very few articles in the USCIS briefing or section of the DHS briefing contain the name of the agency – likely because this agency is mentioned so rarely in the news.

Table A7: Articles from briefings that could be matched by URL to Media Cloud sample.

| Agency | Briefing | Matched | Total | %    |
|--------|----------|---------|-------|------|
| CG     | DHS      | 853     | 1695  | 50.3 |
| DHS    | DHS      | 10591   | 58297 | 18.2 |
| FEMA   | DHS      | 664     | 5096  | 13.0 |
| SS     | DHS      | 928     | 1879  | 49.4 |
| TSA    | DHS      | 364     | 1081  | 33.7 |
| USCBP  | DHS      | 1005    | 3040  | 33.1 |
| USCIS  | DHS      | 19      | 2309  | 0.8  |
| USCIS  | USCIS    | 66      | 24573 | 0.3  |
| USICE  | DHS      | 2389    | 6016  | 39.7 |
| VA     | VA       | 737     | 1899  | 38.8 |

Representativeness of matched vs unmatched articles in briefings

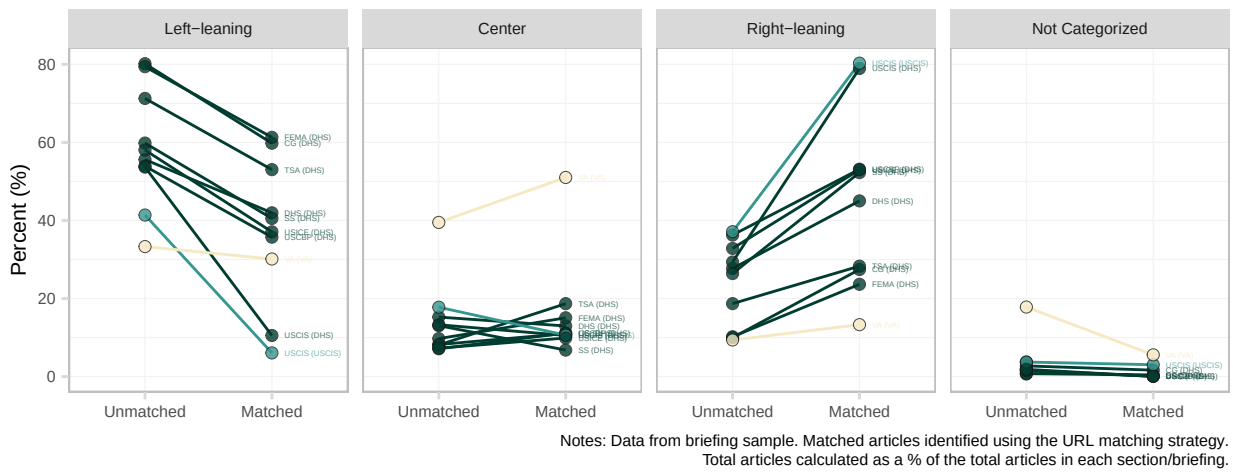


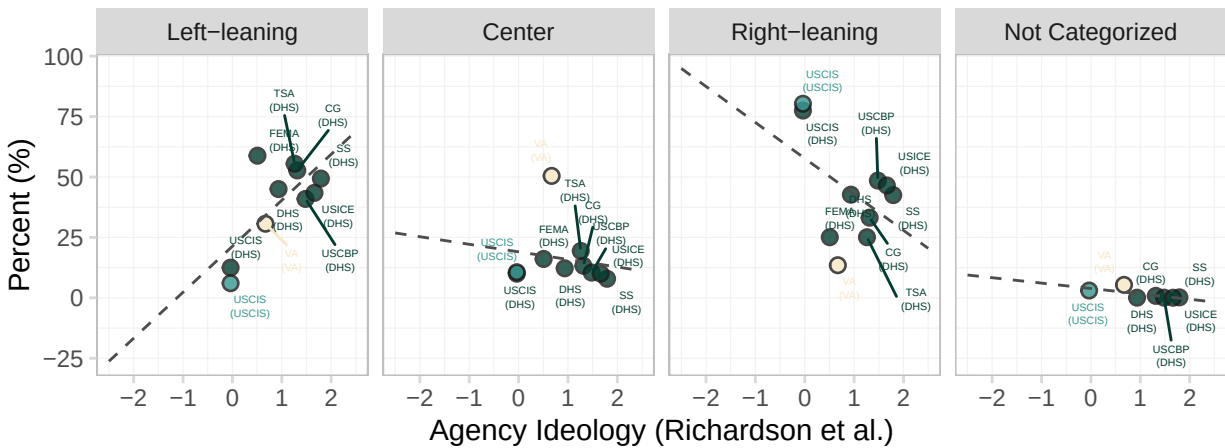
Figure A14: Comparing articles in briefings to subsample of briefings that was matched to the Media Cloud dataset. Matched by URL.

**Are articles with agency names representative of the whole briefing sample?** - To test the representativeness, I then compare the subset of matched articles in the briefing to the whole briefing sample (see Figure A14). This graph shows the proportion of each sample (all articles in briefings vs only articles matched to media cloud sample) in each media slant category. Overall, the proportion of right-leaning news is slightly higher in the matched sample compared to the whole briefing sample, but USCIS is an outlier.

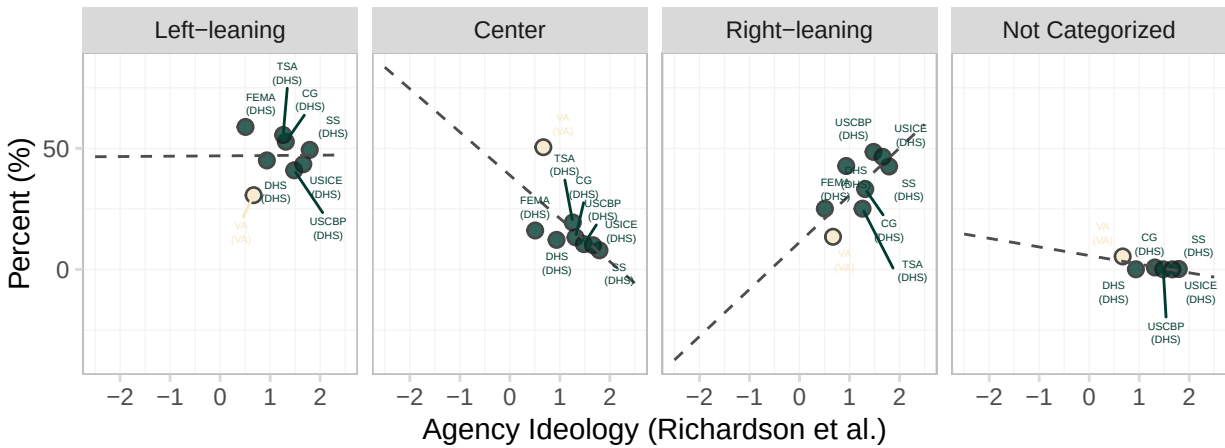
I also verify that the pattern in Figure 1 exists when I limit the briefing sample to only the articles matched to media cloud. If this is not true, I could not use the matched sample to identify the cause of the pattern in Figure 1. To verify this, I isolate the articles in both the briefings and media cloud and use them to replicate Figure 1 (see Figures A15 and A16). Figure A15 replicates Figure 1 using only the articles from the briefings that were matched to the briefing sample by URL. These plots show that the USCIS is a major outlier. But the other agencies generally show the same pattern observed in Figure 1. Figure A16 replicates Figure 1 using only the articles from the briefings that were matched to the briefing sample by Source+Date. These plots also show that the USCIS is a major outlier. But the other agencies generally show the same pattern observed in Figure 1.

## Representativeness of matched articles (URL match)

All Agencies



Drop USCIS

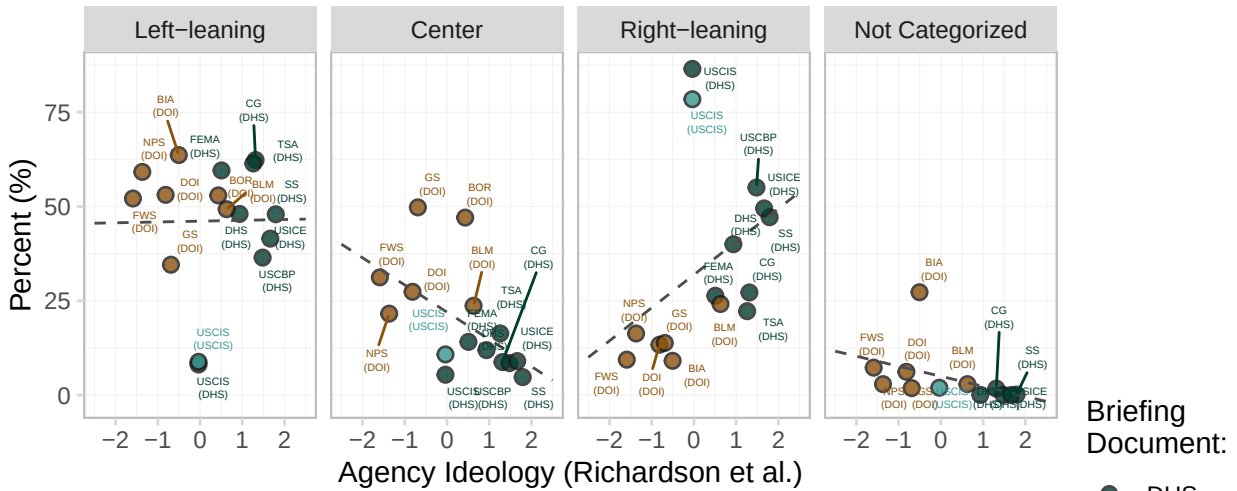


Briefing Document: ● DHS ● USCIS ○ VA

Figure A15: Replication of Figure 1 using only the sources and articles included in the matched dataset (URL match) and the briefings. The y-axis is the proportion of articles in a partisan-slant category (Center, Left-leaning, or Right-leaning). Partisan slant is determined by the source of an article.

## Representativeness of matched articles (Source+Date match)

All Agencies



Drop USCIS

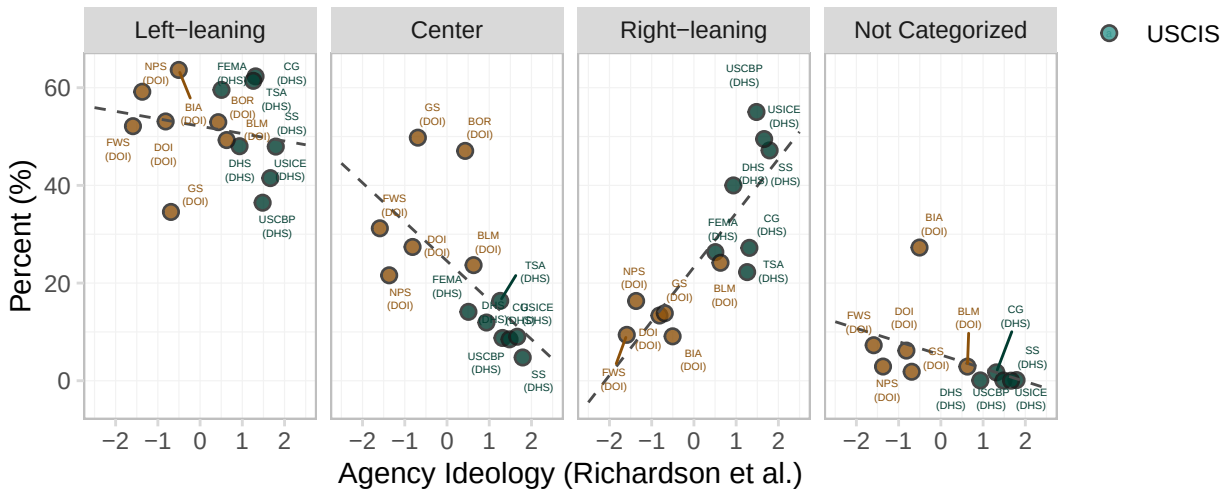


Figure A16: Replication of Figure 1 using only the sources and articles included in the matched dataset (Source+Date match) and the briefings. The y-axis is the proportion of articles in a partisan-slant category (Center, Left-leaning, or Right-leaning). Partisan slant is determined by the source of an article. Dropped yahoo.com.

### A.6. Figure 4 - Testing Biased Selection

Formally, to test whether the slant of an outlet still affects its inclusion after accounting for supply, I use the following model:  $Incl_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 S_i + \beta_2 I_i + \beta_3 (S_i \times I_i) + \epsilon$ . For each article  $i$ ,  $Incl_i$  is 1 if the article is included in the briefing,  $S_i$  is the slant of the news outlet, and  $I_i$  is the ideology of the agency mentioned in the article. If agencies are preferentially selecting articles from ideologically-aligned sources, the interaction between agency ideology and right-leaning slant would be positive. In contrast, the results suggest a weak, possibly negative relationship across multiple specifications.

First, I vary the sample. In Figure A17, I test the following alterations:

- Keep/Drop Yahoo - Depending on the matching strategy, I show what happens when we add or drop Yahoo.com. For the Source+Date match, I keep Yahoo. For the URL match, I drop Yahoo.
- Drop Print - I drop all TV and Radio sources. Because links to outside video/audio hosts, I have fewer website links for articles/clips from TV and Radio sources. Without these links, I cannot match as many radio and tv citations to the Media Cloud data.
- Expanded Domains - By default, I keep only domains that are cited at least once by the company that produces each briefing. Thus, for the DOI, FWS, NPS, etc Media Cloud results, I only keep articles from sources cited in the DOI briefing. Similarly, for the VA Media Cloud results, I only keep articles from sources cited in the VA briefings. For the USCIS and DHS, I keep articles from sources cited in either briefing because they are produced by the same vendor. In this alternate specification, I

allow Media Cloud results to be included if their domains were cited in any of the briefings (DOI, VA, DHS, and USCIS).

- Add Local+Gov - I add back the articles from local general interest news sources and government websites.
- Add Local+Gov+Int - I add back the articles from local general interest news sources, government websites, and international websites.
- Drop Apr-Nov'25 - I drop all articles published after April 1, 2025.
- Keep NA slant - I keep articles from sources with missing slant scores, treating NA slant as a separate category of media slant.
- Drop wire sources - I drop articles from wire sources.
- Drop sources with zero matches - I drop sources that are not successfully matched to the briefing at least once.
- Drop USCIS - I drop articles from the USCIS briefing and USCIS section of the DHS briefing.

Second, I vary the measures of media slant and agency ideology. In Figure A18, I test the following alterations:

- Replace Richardson et al (2018) agency ideology scores with scores from Napolio (2025).
- Replace MBFC partisan slant measures with ones from Allsides; Robertson, Lazer, and Wilson (2018); and Bakshy, Messing, and Adamic (2015).<sup>2</sup> I convert all scores to a 3-category scale (Left-leaning, Center, Right-leaning) to make the results more comparable. I also test a version of the MBFC where center and left-leaning sources are combined into a single center/left category and treated as the reference category.

Lastly, I replicate Figure 4 using the URL matched sample. In Figure A19, the null result is even more evident. This is critical because the URL match strategy is less likely to produce false matches. While only available for half of the sample, the null result in Figure A19 strongly suggests that there is no positive relationship between agency ideology and partisan slant after accounting for disparities in the supply of news.

#### Regression results for Interaction in Figure 4 – Robust to different sample

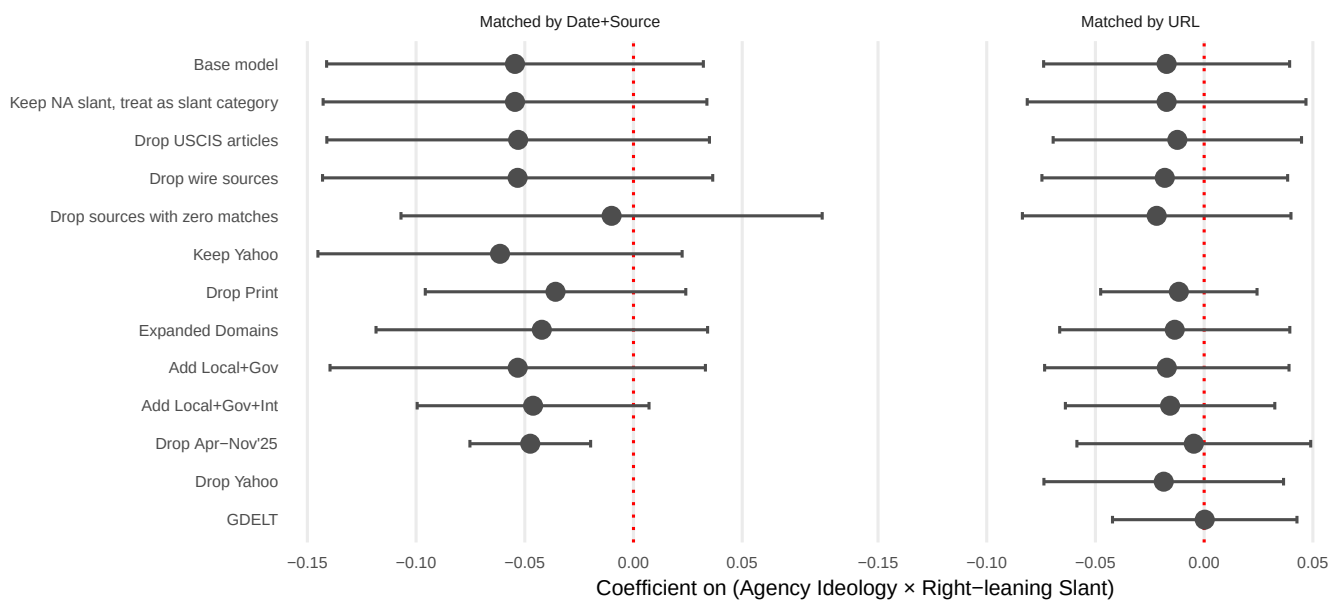


Figure A17: Robustness of interaction effect in Figure 4 to different samples.

<sup>2</sup>Note: the Bakshy et al. scores were downloaded from the replication materials for Guess (2021)



## Regression results for Interaction in Figure 4 – Robust to different measures

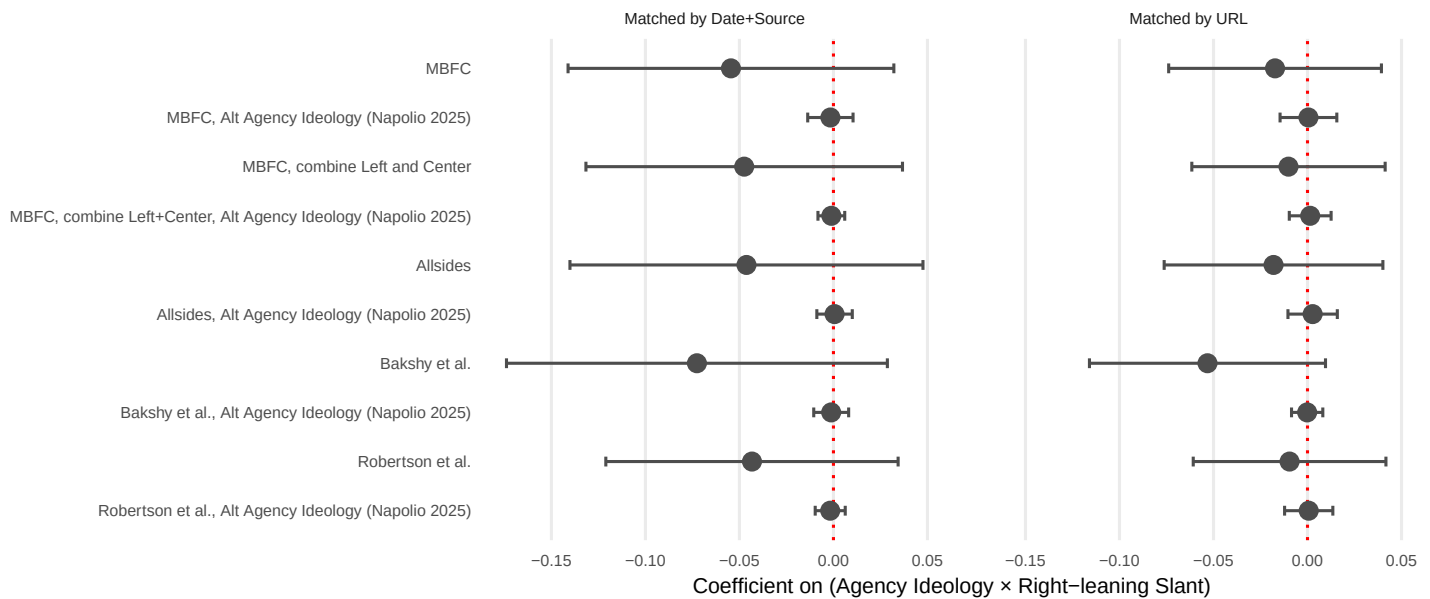


Figure A18: Robustness of interaction effect in Figure 4 to different measures.

## Alternate specifications for Figure 4

### Match by URL

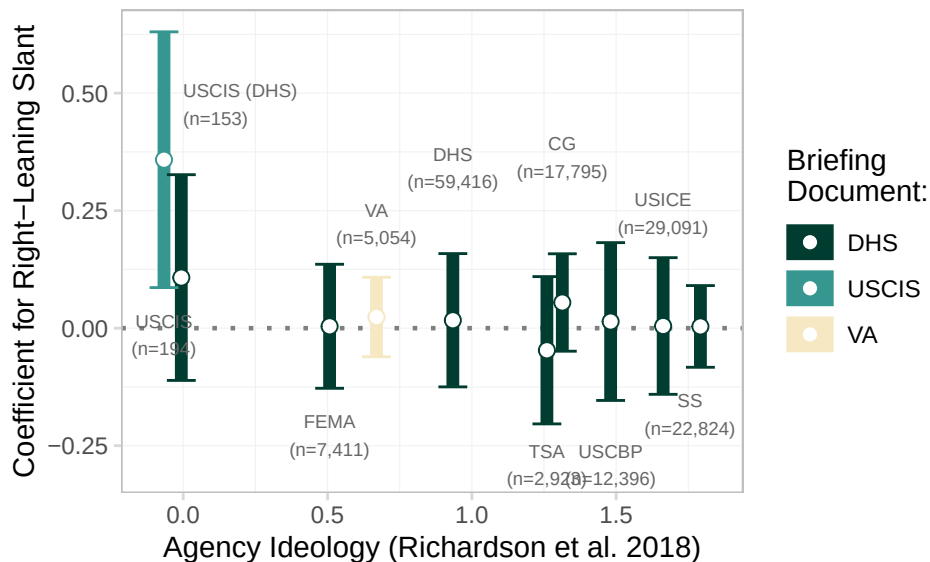


Figure A19: Alternate specifications for Figure 4 - Matched by URL.

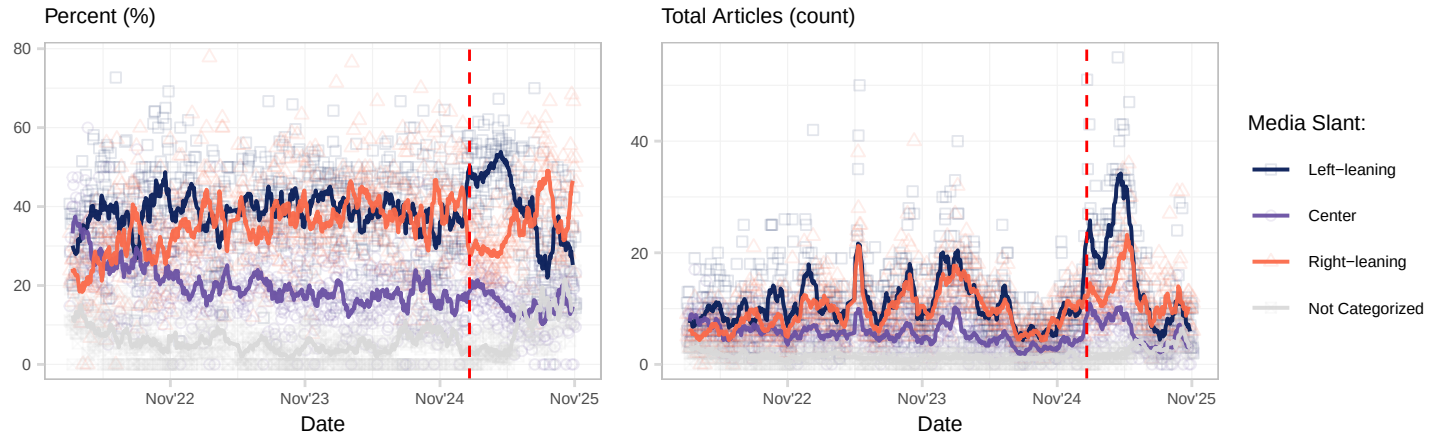
## A.7. Figure 5 - Over-time partisan slant of sources

Figure A20 produces a version of Figure 5 for the other three briefings. Figure A21 shows that the uptick in conservative content is concentrated in the beginning of the DHS briefing.

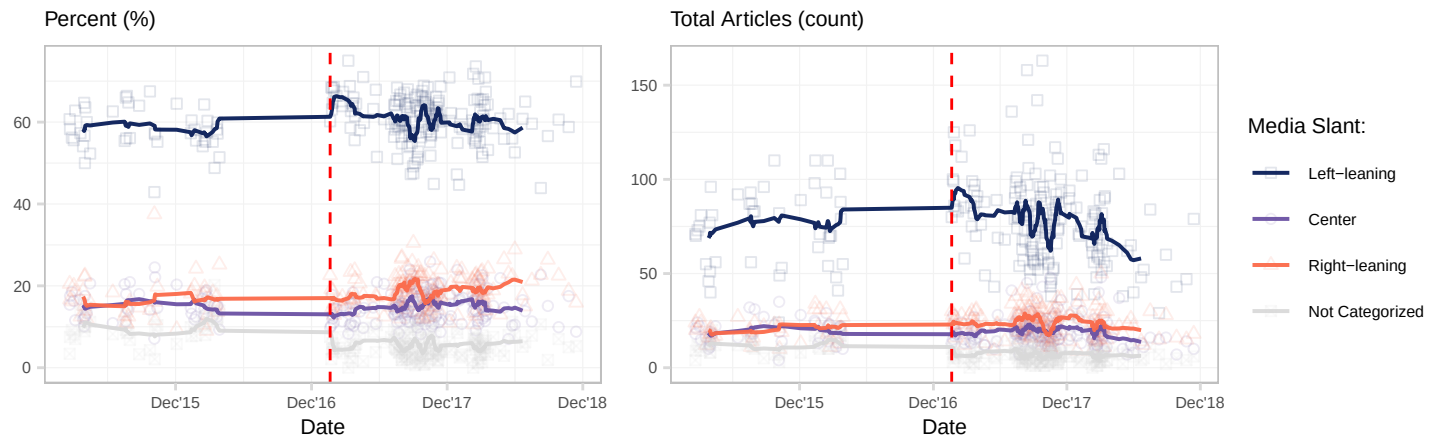
The next set of plots demonstrate the robustness of the pattern in Figure 5. Figure A22 reproduces Figure 5 after adding back local general interest news and government websites. Figures A23, A25, and A27 reproduce Figure 5 using alternative media slant measures.

## Over-time Trends in Partisan Composition of Briefings

### USCIS Briefings



### DOI Briefings



### VA Briefings

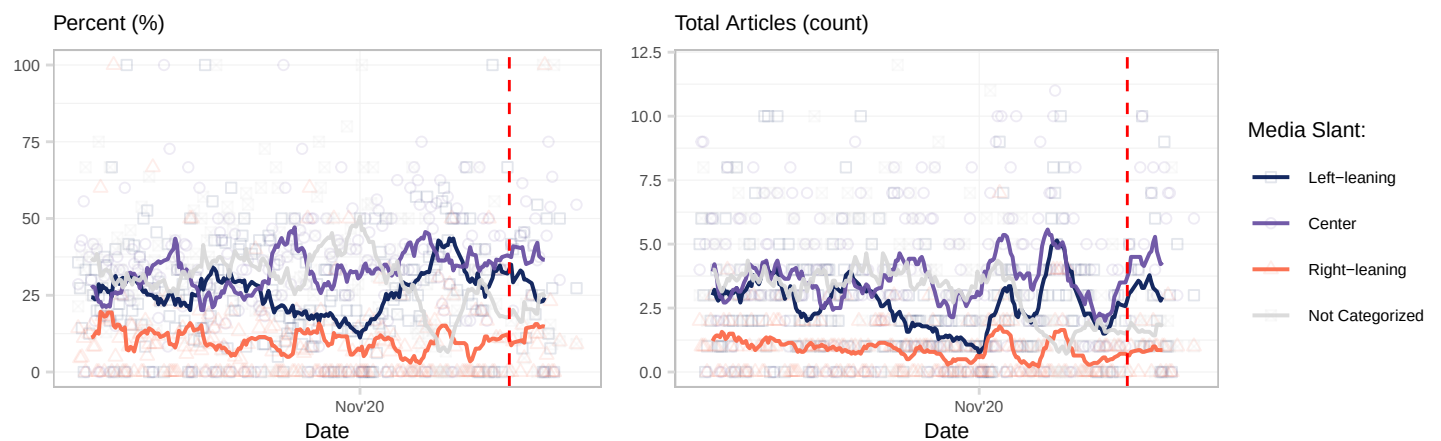
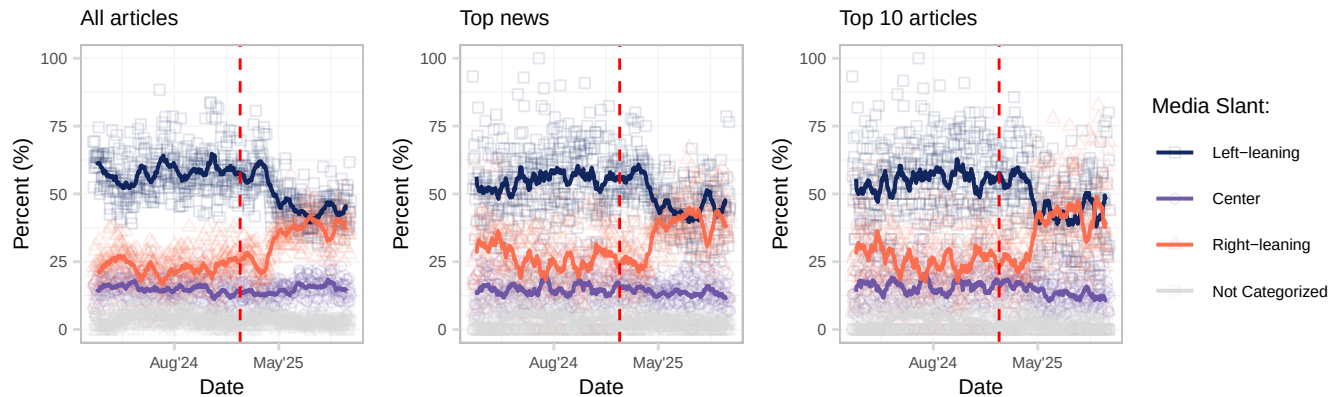


Figure A20: Over-time coverage from partisan sources in the USCIS, VA, and DOI news briefings. Articles from general interest local news sources and government websites are excluded. Partisan media scores from Media Bias Fact Check (MBFC). Dotted line at Trump's 2025 inauguration. Lines are 14-day rolling averages.

## Change in Top News Section DHS Briefings



## USCIS Briefings

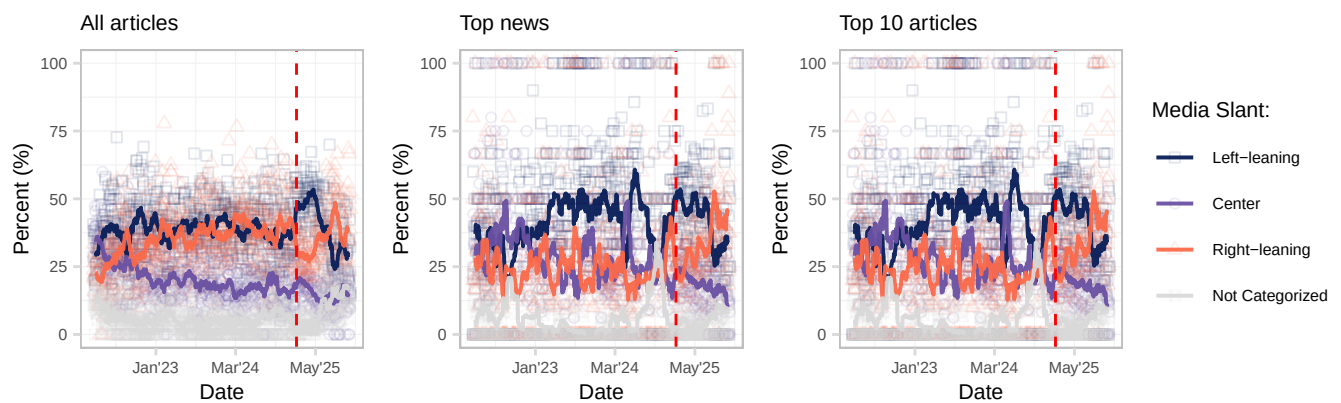


Figure A21: Over-time coverage from partisan sources at the beginning of the DHS and USCIS news briefings. Compares all articles to composition of articles in the 'Top News' section and the composition of the first 10 articles cited in each briefing. Dotted line at Trump's 2025 inauguration. Lines are 3-week rolling averages.

## Keep local general interest sources and government websites

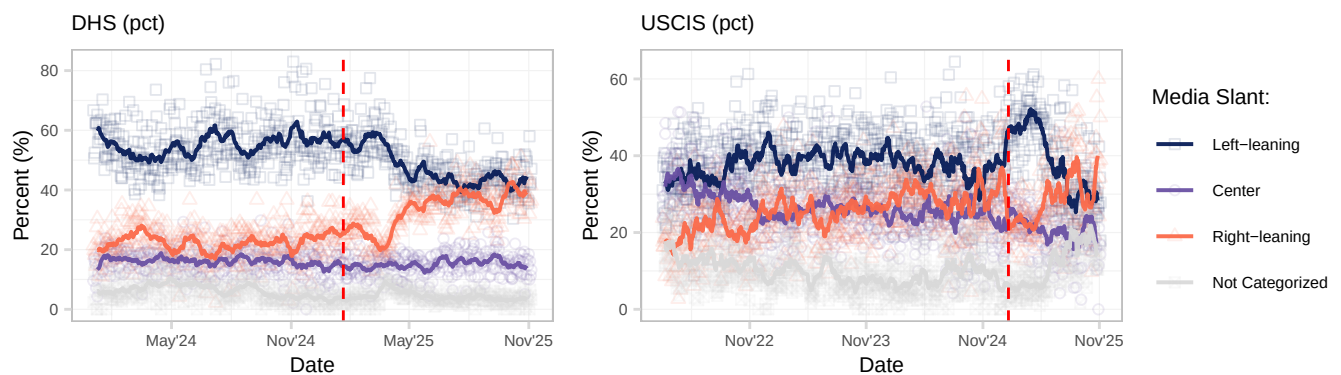


Figure A22: Alternate specifications for Figure 5 - Keep local general interest sources and government websites.

## Over-time Composition of Partisan Bias (Allsides)

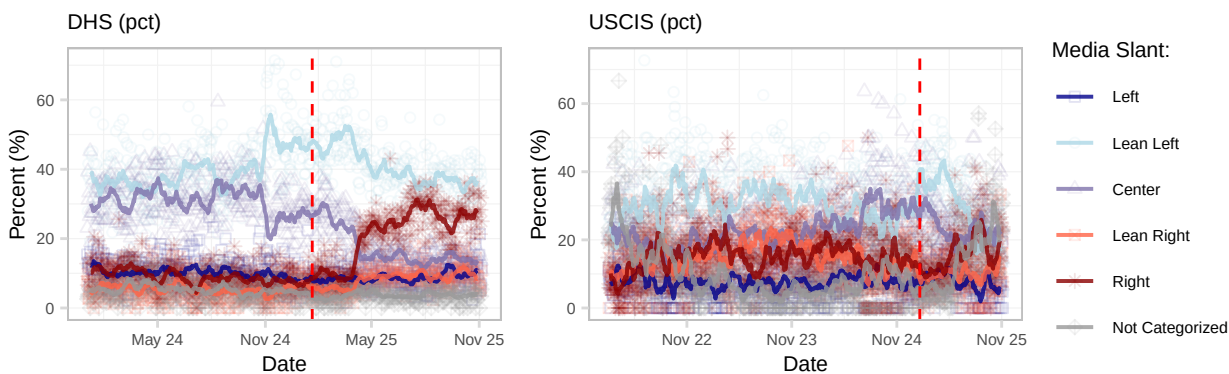


Figure A23: Alternate specifications for Figure 5 - Allsides partisan slant scores. Lines are 2-week rolling averages.

## Over-time Composition of Partisan Bias (Bakshy et al. 2015)

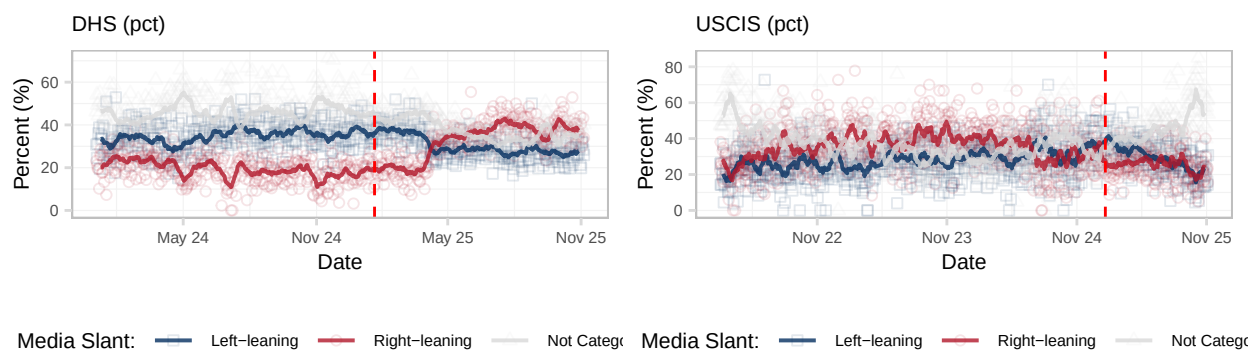


Figure A24: Alternate specifications for Figure 5 - Bakshy, Messing, and Adamic (2015) partisan slant scores. Left/Right-Leaning categories combined with Left/Right categories. Lines are 2-week rolling averages.

## Over-time Composition of Partisan Bias (Robertson et al. 2023)

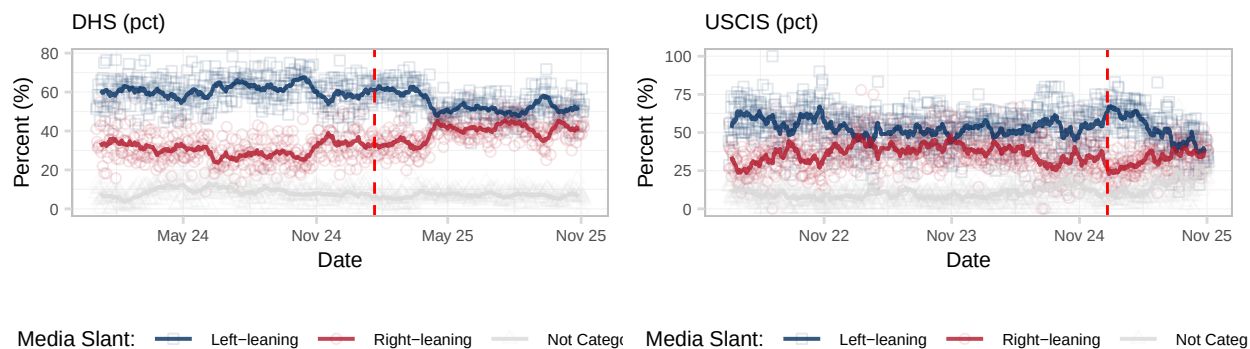


Figure A25: Alternate specifications for Figure 5 - Robertson, Lazer, and Wilson (2018) partisan slant scores. Left/Right-Leaning categories combined with Left/Right categories. Lines are 2-week rolling averages.

## Average partisan slant score from Bakshy, Messing, and Adamic (2015)

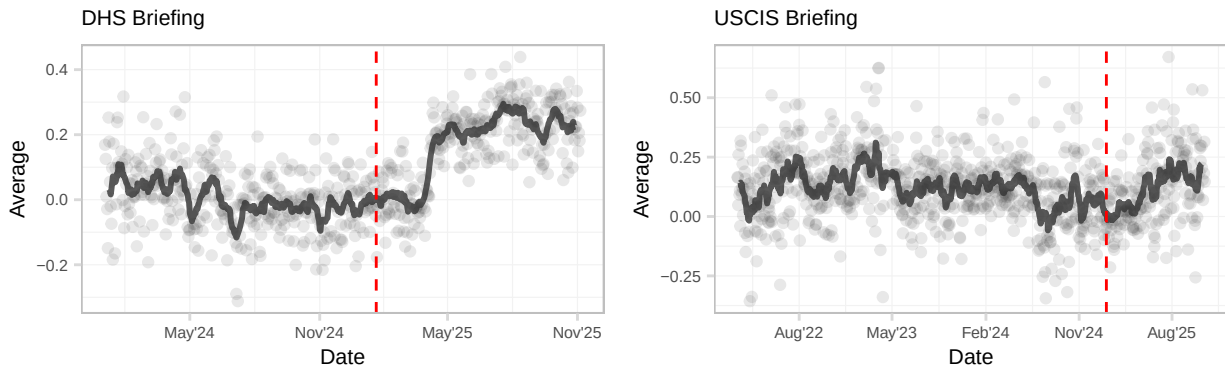


Figure A26: Average partisan bias score from Bakshy, Messing, and Adamic (2015) Lines are 2-week rolling averages.

## Average partisan slant score from Robertson, Lazer, and Wilson (2018)

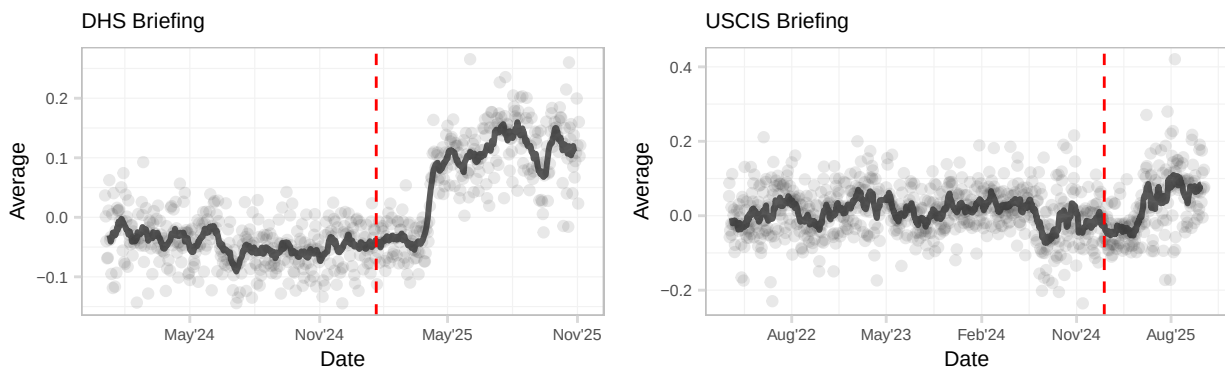


Figure A27: Average partisan bias score from Robertson, Lazer, and Wilson (2018). Lines are 2-week rolling averages.

To visualize how the composition of the DHS and USCIS briefings changed in early 2025, I identified sources that Media Bias/Fact Check considered extreme. To do this, I used a continuous version of the MBFC score.<sup>3</sup> Continuous scores are only available for 48.8% of the sources in the briefings, which is why I use the categorical version elsewhere. The continuous scores range from -10 (most left-leaning) and 10 (most right-leaning). I labeled scores as extreme if they were above 5 or below -5. If the source did not have a continuous score, I labeled it as 'unknown.' In Figure A28, I plot the number of new sources appearing in the briefings by month. Sources are only counted if they have never been included in the briefing previously. I break down sources by their MBFC categorical score and extremity.

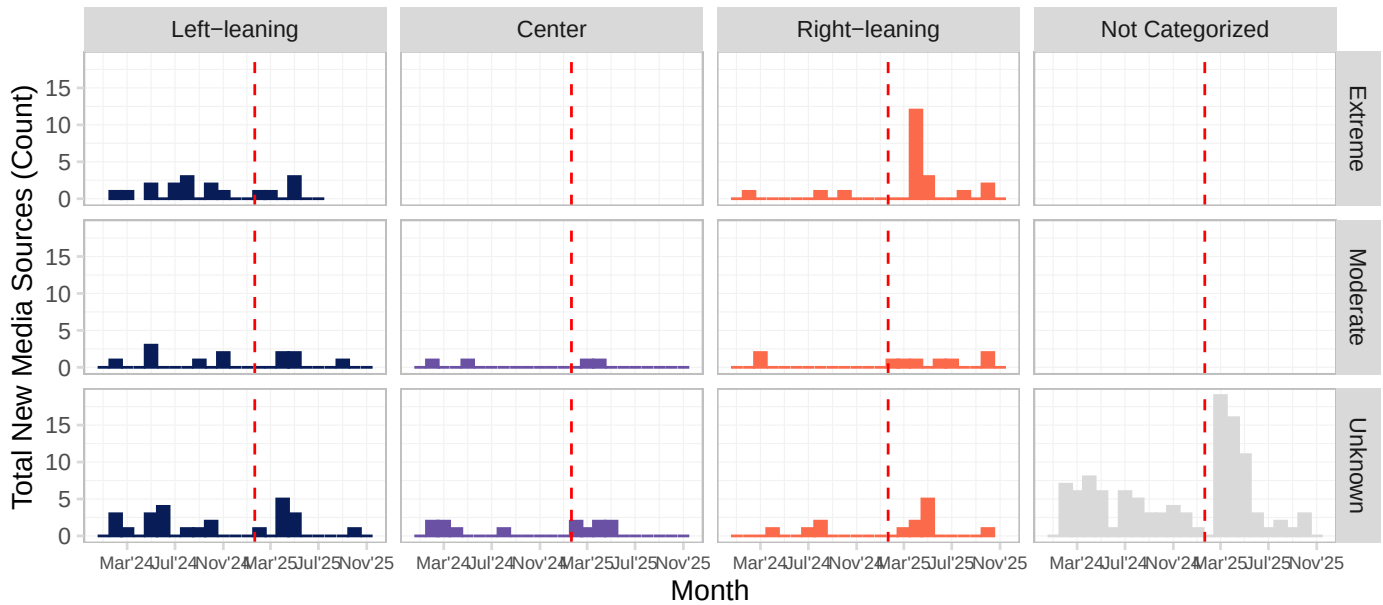
Figure A28 shows that an abnormally large number of extreme right-leaning sources were added to the DHS and USCIS briefings around April 2025. Even though the overall composition of the USCIS briefings was less affected, Figure A28 reveals how far-right sources were added to both briefings. The plot also illustrates how this influx of partisan sources deviates from prior time periods. When I produce similar plots for the DOI or VA briefings, the pattern of added sources is stable across presidential transitions. I also explored the spike in new 'not categorized' sources after Trump's inauguration. Because each of these sources contributes a small number of articles to the briefings, they represent a small change to the composition of both briefings.

<sup>3</sup>After dropping local general interest source, government websites, and sources not found in any briefing, the continuous values range from -9.6 to 9.8. The mean is -0.32 and the median is -1.3. The standard deviation is 4.81.



# Partisan Extremity of New Sources Added to Briefings Each Month

## DHS Briefings (2024–2025)



## USCIS Briefings (2022–2025)

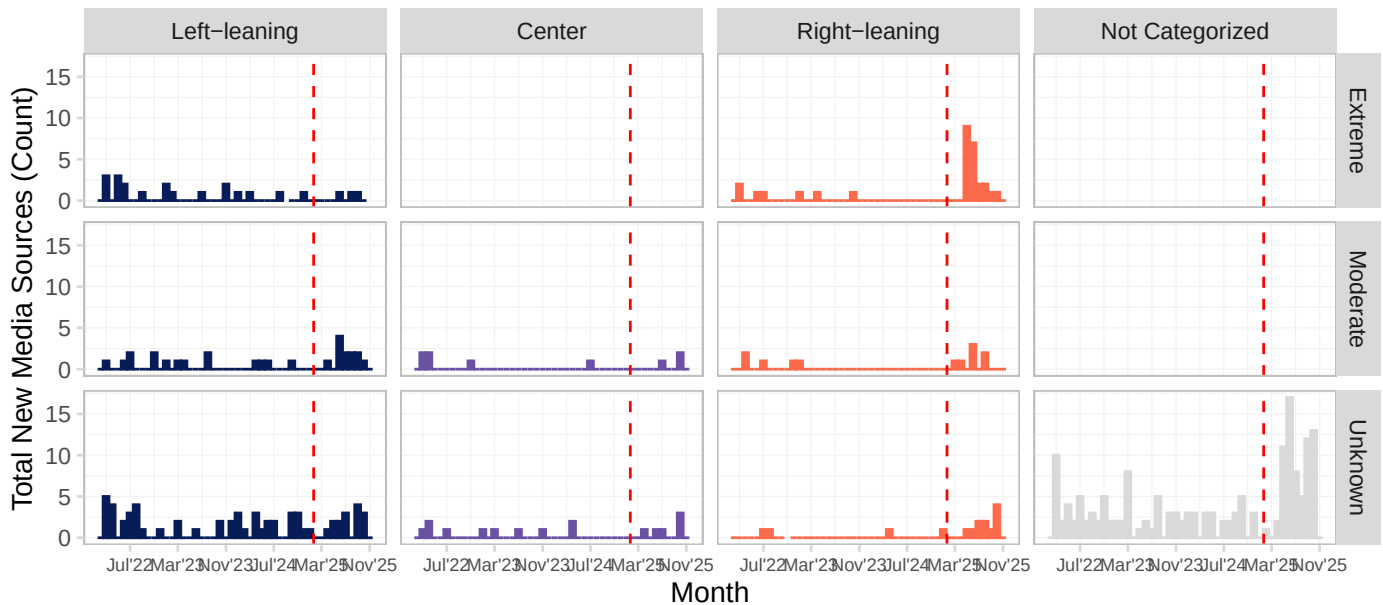


Figure A28: Number of new sources added to USCIS and DHS news briefings by month. Continuous MBFC scores are available for fewer news sources. Source extremity labeled as 'Unknown' if no continuous score is available.

### A.8. Extension of Figure 5 Analysis - Using matched data to analyze selection over-time

In theory, the matched data could also be used to test whether supply explains the pattern of conservative in the briefings after March 2025. However, this comparison requires that the quality matched sample is stable over time and representative of the over-time changes in the content of the briefings. Below, I show that the matched sample is not representative. Although the point estimates suggest that the increase in right-leaning news is due to preferential selection, we should be cautious interpreting these results.

For this analysis, I use several variations of the matched data. First, I either (a) keep all of the sources cited at least once in the briefings, or I keep only the sources successfully matched at least once to the briefings. Next, I show the results for two different sets of keywords. (i) First, I show what happens when I only keep the articles that mention “Homeland Security” (DHS only). (ii) Second, I show what happens when I stack the data for all of the agencies in the DHS briefings (DHS agencies/DHS briefing). For each subagency, I search for its name in the Media Cloud database, stack the resulting set of articles, and match the stacked data to

the entire DHS briefing. If an article is included anywhere on the DHS briefing, the DV (included) = 1.

Unless stated otherwise, I cluster by source and url. Partisan bias is assigned at the source-level. Because the data is stacked, an article could be included multiple times if it mentions multiple DHS agencies.

For the regression results, I modify the previous regression from A.5.2 to test whether the partisan leaning of an article's source has become predictive of inclusion in the news briefings after March 2025. For completeness, I test this using two samples. First, I run the regression using all of the matched data for all nine DHS agencies and cluster by agency. Second, I run a simpler model with only the matched Media Cloud results for "Homeland Security."

Without knowing the true number of articles published by each outlet, assessing the quality of Media Cloud's data collection is difficult. However, there is some evidence that the quality of Media Cloud's data collection varies over time, which could affect comparison across administrations.

Articles from the following sources change substantially partway through 2024:

- "bizpacreview.com" - missing after Sept 2024
- "business-standard.com" - only available from Sept to Oct 2024
- "cis.org" - missing after July 2024
- "ctvnews.ca" - missing after Jan 2025
- "politico.com" - missing after Feb 2024
- "thedailybeast.com" - missing after Oct 2024
- "voanews.com" - missing after march2024
- "washingtonpost.com" - missing after March 2024
- "washingtontimes.com" - missing after July 2024
- "theblaze.com" - highly reduced sample after Sept 2024
- "yahoo.com" - total articles drop by around 50-75% after October 2024

Unless stated otherwise, I drop all of the sources that stop being included in the Media Cloud sample. I keep blaze.com and yahoo.com, but I have experimented with dropping these as well. Doing so does not change the results.

As an initial test, I first plot the number of articles from each type of source over time, limiting the sample to only the articles matched to the Media Cloud sample (see Figure A29). If the Media Cloud sample is complete and articles are accurately matched by URL, this should reveal the composition of the articles that mention the DHS agencies by name. If the over-time pattern in the matched data is representative of the full briefing sample, we would expect to see the over-time patterns generally match. The level/intercept for each slant category may differ because it depends the exact set of sources included in the matched sample; however, the relative patterns should match. However, as can be seen in Figure A29, the trend-lines for liberal and conservative sources are very similar in the matched data. In comparison, in the actual briefing, the amount of news from liberal vs conservative sources diverge at times.

I plot different subsets of the DHS briefing data to test whether this discrepancy is because the matched sample only contains a subset of the sources in the full briefing. If so, we would expect the briefing data trendlines to differ when restricted to the sources in the matched sample. In Figure A30, I test a more expansive and a more restrictive set of matched sample sources. First, I test what happens when the briefing sample is restricted to the domains that exist in both the matched sample and one of the TechMIS briefings (DHS or USCIS). Second, I restrict the briefing sample to only domains that were successfully matched at least once to the briefing dataset. In either case, the pattern in Figure A30 is very similar to the whole briefing sample (Figure 5 in the paper).

## Is matched-data representative? Probably not.

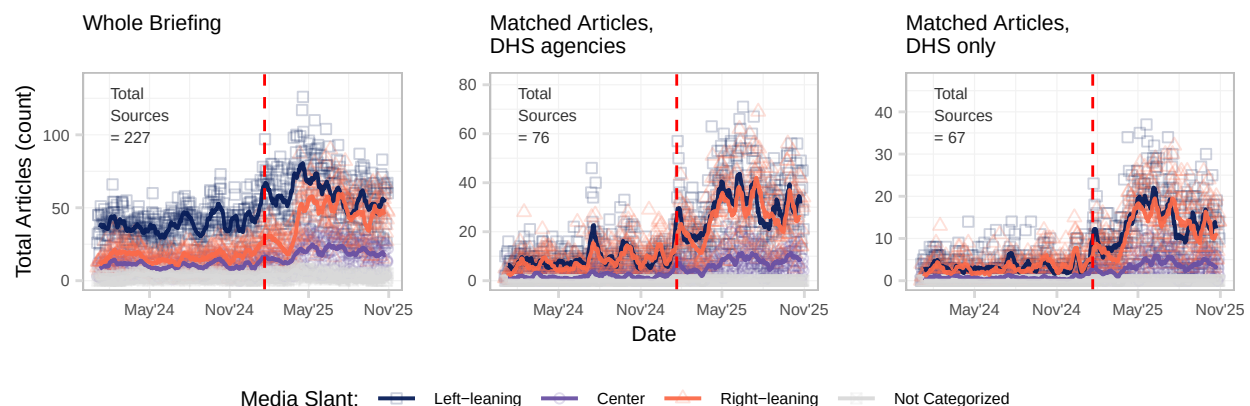


Figure A29: Over-time representativeness of DHS matched sample (included=1 only). Replication of Fig 5 in paper with media cloud articles that were matched to briefings. Dotted line at Trump's 2025 inauguration. Lines are 14-day rolling averages. Drops sources with incomplete Media Cloud data and international sources.

## Composition of whole media cloud matched sample

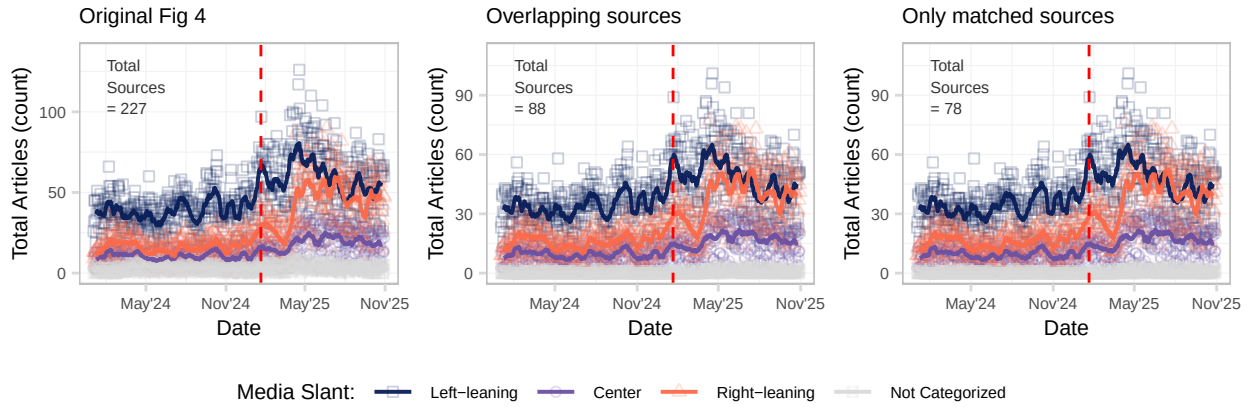


Figure A30: Over-time trend in DHS briefing data. Replication of Fig 5 in paper with domains in matched sample. Dotted line at Trump's 2025 inauguration. Lines are 14-day rolling averages. Drops sources with incomplete Media Cloud data and international sources. Includes articles that mention DHS or one of its subagencies by name.

Regardless, we can test over-time changes in the supply of articles that mention DHS or one of its subagencies by name. Figure A31 shows the composition of the whole matched sample (including articles not matched to the DHS briefing) over time. It shows the composition when we look at all articles that mention DHS by name ("DHS only") and when we look at articles that mention DHS or any of the 7 DHS subagencies ("USICE", "USCIS", "USCBP", "FEMA", "CG", "TSA", "SS") by name ("DHS Agencies").

## Supply of news about DHS and DHS agencies

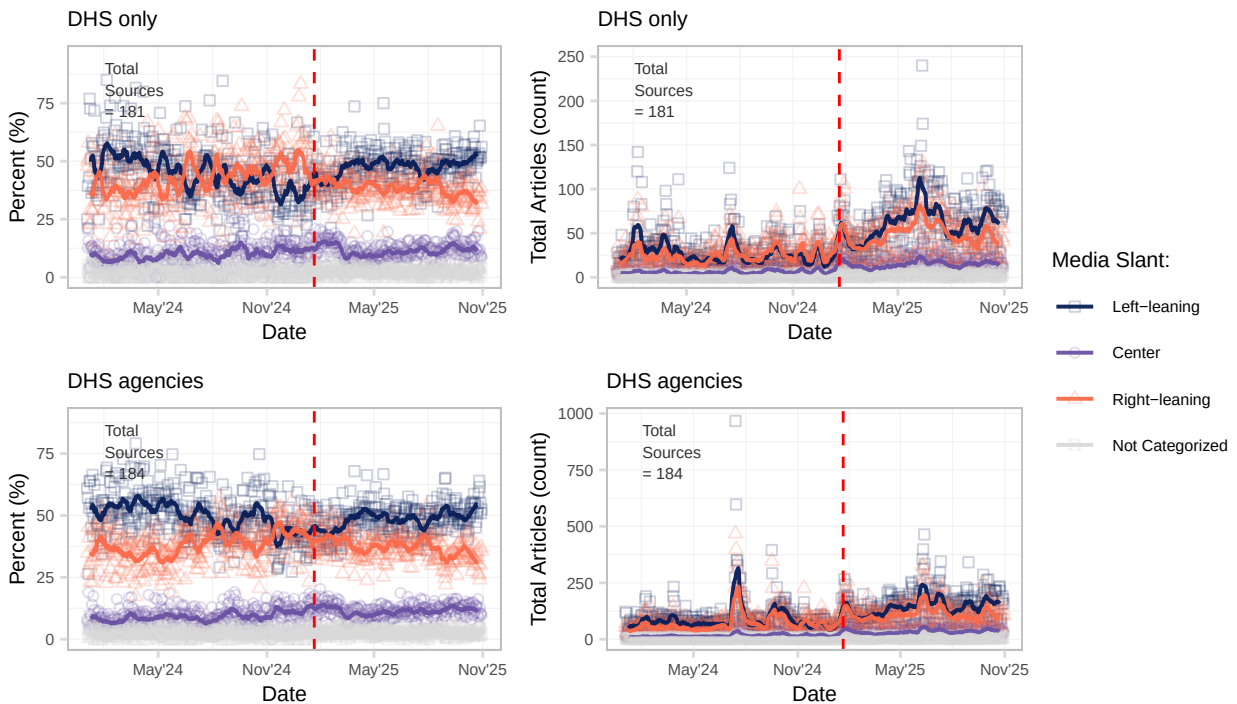


Figure A31: Partisan composition of articles in matched sample of data from Media Cloud. Sources limited to those found in TechMIS briefings (DHS and USCIS). Dotted line at Trump's 2025 inauguration. Lines are 14-day rolling averages. Drops sources with incomplete Media Cloud data and international sources.

Next, we can calculate the probability that an article is included over time. When we look at the percent of articles that are matched to the briefings (included=1) in each partisan slant category (right-leaning, left-leaning, center, or not categorized article), we see that right-leaning articles appear to be included more often around April 2025 (see Figure A32). However, the change is not significant.



## What % of articles are included in the DHS briefing?

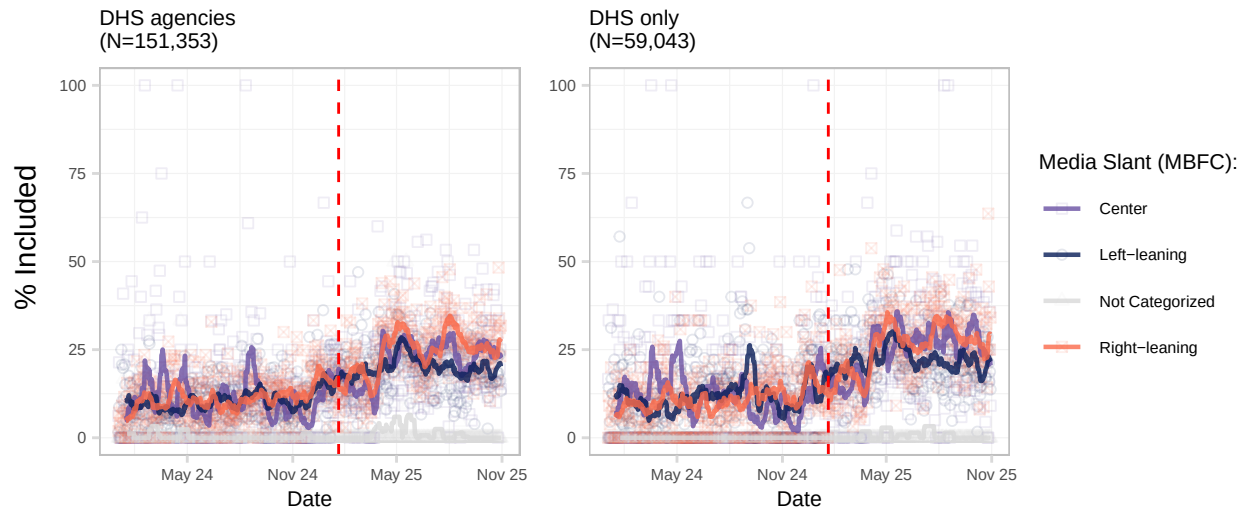


Figure A32: Over-time probability of coverage by partisan source category in the DHS news briefings. Sample limited to agencies in the DHS briefing. Outcome variable is binary indicator (1 if article included in news summary, 0 otherwise). Articles from general interest local news sources and government websites are excluded. Partisan media scores from Media Bias Fact Check (MBFC). Dotted line at Trump's 2025 inauguration. Lines are 14-day right-aligned rolling averages (for each date, average includes values for that date and 13 previous values).